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Wellington & District
LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharéena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbone and Yeoval districts.

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 No. 214 THURSDAY, December 18, 2025 ISSN 2653-2026

Home for Christmas?
 Then bring the family
 for a relaxing afternoon
 at
BOXING DAY RACES
Friday, 26 December

\$2.50
 Inc GST

**Stay safe near water
this summer - P3**

**This is the last edition for 2025
our next edition will be
published on Thursday,
January 15, 2026**

**History of Walmer
- P6**

Merry Christmas



and a Happy and Healthy 2026

Unwind after a hectic Christmas day and take the family and visitors to

Boxing Day Races

Join in for a day of thrilling races, live music with *Mick, Tracie and Deb*, food and great company.
 Why not bring your Christmas leftovers for a picnic.
It's the ultimate recovery day after the festive season with bookmaker ring, TAB facilities and Gates opening and fun starting from 12 midday.

**Adults: \$10 * Pensioners & concessions \$5
Under 16 Free**



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Much achieved at December Ordinary Meeting

December Council Meeting Outcomes
Smart Water Meters – Taggle: Dubbo Regional Council is aware of issues relating to water meters not working properly and has been working with the supplier to reach an agreement since 2024. As a result of the issues experienced and the delay in action, Council engaged legal representation. Council have now determined to start court proceedings against the meter supplier, Taggle. Council will continue to estimate usage based on a corresponding period where required as permitted under the Local Government (General) Regulation 2021 Section 158 until the matter is resolved. ***

Results of Public Exhibition – Planning Proposal R24-004 - Residential Accommodation in the Wellington E2 Commercial Centre Zone: Council noted the submissions received during the public exhibition period and adopted the proposal to amend the Dubbo Regional Local Environmental Plan 2022. This will see types of residential accommodation such as Shop Top Housing able

to be built in the Wellington Commercial Centre Zone. ***
Temporary Workers Accommodation: Council approved Development Application for Temporary Workers Accommodation at locations in Gisborne Street and Pierce Street Wellington, subject to Conditions of Development Consent. Review of Community Halls: The General Manager will review Council’s Community Buildings portfolio in consultation with stakeholders and present a report to Council outlining options to enhance sustainable asset maintenance, strengthen risk management, and improve the delivery of community services in a financially sustainable manner. The cost to ratepayers to upgrade all Community Halls to a really good standard would be pushing \$10 million ***
Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund - Review: Council will maintain the status quo, with the following additions to be considered as part of a refined process review in consultation with

the Iberdrola Bodangora Wind Farm Community Consultative Committee (BWFCCC). The additions include the update of the application form to clearly identify ineligible entities and projects; a summary and eligibility review of all applications received be provided to BWFCCC for notation before the evaluation of the eligible applications; BWFCCC members meet, discuss applications and provide recommendations to DRC for successful applications, including dollar value of the funding and DRC considers recommendations of the BWFCCC. The Round 11 funding opportunity will be made available in the new year. ***
Wellington High School Presentation Evening I was honoured to attend a wonderful presentation evening at Wellington High School this week. It was a fantastic celebration of student achievement for the year and speaks volumes to the dedication of the school students, community and staff. Obviously, not every student can win a

prize, but after 22 years of high school teaching I have come to the conclusion that any student that attends as much as they can, always does their best whilst being kind to others, is a winner in my book. ***
Road Projects Delayed Our road crews do more than maintain roads, they also help keep our community safe. They’re responsible for 1520km of sealed roads and 1356km of unsealed roads, but when emergencies strike, they step up. Over the past few weeks, our teams have been on the firegrounds across the region and at motor vehicle accidents, supporting emergency services. This vital work meant some regular road projects were paused or delayed. Once conditions improve, crews will return to their usual maintenance schedule. You can keep up-to-date with the planned schedule on the DRC webpage. ***
Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year to all readers. I hope that the festive season is a wonderful and safe time to relax and recharge the batteries for 2026.
Josh Black

Fewer than 3 per cent ‘don’t read news’

AUSTRALIANS STILL value trusted news, and the latest Roy Morgan data proves it. According to new research reported by GX, fewer than three per cent of Australians go a month without reading news. That means 97pc of people aged 14 and over engage with news media monthly. New figures indicate reading news content is “more common than supermarket visits and 2.8-time more trusted than social media. In real terms, that is 22.4 million Australians turning to news more often than they visit the supermarket, eat a piece of fruit or drink a cup of coffee. News is not only widely consumed, it is trusted.

The findings show news publishing is 2.8 times more trusted than social media, with more than 28pc of Australians naming news as their most trusted source of current affairs. Only 10pc say the same about social platforms. Addressable reach also remains strong. News publishing reaches 97.1pc of Australians each month, even after excluding people using ad blockers or ad free subscriptions. Weekly reach stands at 87pc, placing news third behind video and social. For regional communities, this reinforces the essential role of independent journalism in informing, connecting and serving the public.

Government Cash Mandate a dud – Gee continues fight to “Keep Cash King”

THE FEDERAL Government’s draft regulation on a cash mandate sells out vulnerable Australians and rural communities, according to Independent Federal Member for Calare, Andrew Gee. “The draft cash mandate is an absolute dud! It does nothing more than require supermarket giants and big fuel companies to keep cash for transactions of \$500 or less,” Mr Gee said. “It’s giving the green light for phasing out cash in Australia, when we should be preserving the cash economy. “Australians who want to use cash will be abandoned. In country areas there are many people who don’t buy their food and groceries from the big retailers.” In Question Time recently, Mr Gee again challenged the Government on why it won’t support his private Members Bill Keeping Cash Transactions in Australia. “My Bill would mandate that businesses operat-

ing in any face-to-face settings, must accept cash for transactions that don’t exceed \$10,000 – keeping cash King,” he said. “The Government’s draft regulation is a cop-out – it doesn’t go far enough to ensure that Australians can choose how they will pay for what they buy. “Shockingly, while the law provides that banknotes and coins are legal tender, there is currently no legal requirement for cash to be accepted for transactions in Australia. “Not everyone is able or wants to use online banking services. People worry about facing additional fees and surcharges, giving up their privacy, and dealing with the risk of fraud. “I’ll say it again – Australians should have a choice as to how they spend their hard-earned dollars. I will not be giving up the fight to keep cash King in Australia.”

More job cuts as Fair Trading complaints surge

NATIONALS UPPER House MP Nichole Overall has condemned the state Government amid fresh revelations of yet another wave of public sector job cuts targeting the frontline agency charged with protecting consumers as complaints surge. “The Office of Fair Trading has seen strata disputes increase by 11 per cent to almost 2800, or 53 per week, over the last financial year, according to Ms Overall. “At the same time, the agency has been subjected to a ‘restructure’ that the Public Service Association of NSW has stated will result in between 120 and 130 jobs being axed, including in regional areas,” she said. “In Parliament, I asked Labor about

these job cuts at Fair Trading, that include the critical Loose-Fill Asbestos program. “The response? That Labor makes no apology – even as workers, with little warning, face the axe before Christmas. “Fair Trading’s ‘new’ complaints handling system is already a disaster – as confirmed to me by those working in these very areas – and in the midst of escalating complaints, Labor gets rid of the very people meant to deal with them,” she said. “Staff say there’s a better way to fix the backlog and deal with these matters - but no one wants to listen. It seems it’s all about the Treasurer trying to patch up his budget.” With concerns raised by the PSA in

relation to a lack of engagement and proper process, Mrs Overall has called on the government to produce documents to provide clarification. “Labor loves to talk up their transparency and yet, they’ve tried to dance around all of this,” Ms Overall said. “It’s being made public because I’ve drawn attention to it, following my conversations with the union and affected workers. “To use language these experienced staff members know well, it seems they’ve been sold a pup. “They deserve answers around the lack of proper process, poor engagement and promises made to them that don’t stack up.”

Wellington & District
LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O’Brien
Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed
for publication in the “Leader”
Contact: mark@wdleader.news



Stay safe in and around rivers this summer

WITH THE weather heating up, the regional council is urging young residents to make safety their top priority when enjoying inland waterways.

The Macquarie and Bell Rivers are central to Wellington with a number of popular recreational swimming spots throughout the region.

However, they can pose hidden dangers that may not be apparent when just looking at the surface.

Mayor Josh Black said Council was urging residents to be safe in, on and around water this summer.

“Being safe is about knowing your limits and avoiding the risks,” he said.

“It’s important to check the conditions before you enter the water whether that is a river, lake or dam.

“It is also important that young people don’t overestimate their ability and underestimate the dangers in rivers.

“The summer school holidays are fast approaching, and we are encouraging parents and carers to talk to their young people about being safe when swimming and using our inland waterways.”

Some key points parents and carers can use when speaking to their child include: Making sure they check the current before entering the water – river currents can change due to rainfall and releases from Burrendong dam; Making sure they check for submerged objects such as rocks and tree branches with a stick. Don’t dive into the water, always enter the water slowly, feet first; Take care on uneven surfaces and steep slippery riverbanks; Never swim alone, always with a mate; Wear a life jacket when boating or using watercraft.

According to the Royal Life Saving NSW 80 per cent of all drowning deaths were males and 40pc drowned less than 20km from where they lived. (Statistics from 2012 – 2021).

Water safety starts with yourself.
Caution is necessary.
Always check what may be hidden from view under water.
It’s important to look after yourself, and any other person with you.
Always remember - it CAN happen to me, so be safe in and around water.

Holiday Times

Last Tai Chi class Fri 19 December
Special Shop opening hours
Sat 20 & Sun 21 December
Centre Closes Mon 22 December
Reopens Sunday 1 February
Empathetic Counselling
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bulabul battery



AMPYR

Backing local initiatives through the Bulabul Community Fund

Communities in the Wellington area have a new opportunity to bring local community projects to life, with the launch of the Bulabul Battery Community Fund, a \$100,000 program designed to support initiatives that strengthen the region socially, culturally and environmentally.

Grants of up to \$10,000 available

The Fund, established by AMPYR Australia as part of its ongoing commitment to the Bulabul Battery project, offers grants of up to \$10,000 for eligible organisations. The fund is targeting non-profit organisations, school or educational groups and other local organisations that provide community or environmental services and is open for applications from Wellington, Montefiores, Guerie, Stuart Town, Yeoval, Bodangora, Mumbil and Dripstone.

The program recognises community wellbeing is shaped by many different elements, and invites applications across a range of priorities, including First Nations initiatives, community enrichment, education, health and wellbeing, sustainability, arts and culture, sporting groups and small-scale infrastructure upgrades.



AMPYR Australia Project Director Anthony Yeates says the Fund has been designed with local needs in mind.

“We’ve had lots of conversations with people from the community that highlighted a desire for practical support – funding that could help local organisations pursue their work in the community,” Mr Yeates said.

“For this first round of funding, we are particularly focused on opportunities to assist in community enrichment, education programs and health and wellbeing initiatives.”

Applications due 9 January 2026

Applications for both the Community Fund and Community Reference Group close at **5pm on Friday 9 January 2026**. Full guidelines, eligibility criteria and application forms can be found at www.ampry.com/our-projects/bulabul-battery.



“We are planning another round of funding in roughly 12 months’ time, and we’d love to hear about the types of initiatives that people would like to see supported. Longer term, we will be continuing our funding via a Planning Agreement that we have signed up for that will see us working with Dubbo Regional Council to support the community for at least the next 20 years.”



• **Community enrichment:** Examples include community-wide events, youth activities and programs.



• **Education programs:** Examples include educational programs and tours, educational resources, scholarships and donations towards students.



• **Health and wellbeing:** Examples include initiatives that promote/enhance healthy living, health care, childcare, mental health care or assistance to disadvantaged groups, support during an emergency.

Working with the community

The Community Fund is one of the project’s first benefit-sharing initiatives, developed to ensure the social and economic advantages of the energy transition are felt locally.

To help guide how benefits are delivered over time, AMPYR is also seeking expressions of interest from residents to join the Bulabul Battery Community Reference Group. This group will play an advisory role during project construction and early operations, ensuring community views continue to shape decision making. Members will also provide recommendations on future funding priorities and help monitor how benefits flow back into the region.

Eligible organisations delivering services within the local community are encouraged to apply. Proposed projects should be “project ready” and able to begin within 12 months.

WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER, THURSDAY, DECEMBER 18, 2025, 3

AMPYR launches Bulabul Battery Community Fund for local projects

A NEW grants program of up to \$100,000 has just been released by AMPYR Australia when it launched the Bulabul Battery Community Fund a fortnight ago.

The program designed to deliver lasting benefits will provide grants of up to \$10,000 for eligible community organisations, schools, volunteer groups and local service providers, but focus on projects that meet the following priorities:

First Nations initiatives; Community engagement and enrichment; Education; Health and wellbeing.

AMPYR will also support funding for the following priorities: Environment and sustainability; Arts and culture; Sporting groups; Infrastructure and refurbishment.

AMPYR is also seeking Expressions of Interest for local people to participate in the Bulabul Battery Community Reference Group.

The Community Reference Group will act as key advisory body during project construction and early operation, ensuring that community views continue to shape the project and inform how future community benefits are shared locally.

The Bulabul Battery, located at Maryvale, will strengthen NSW's energy system, and create long-term social and

economic benefits for the region.

The Community Fund is one of the project's first formal benefit sharing initiatives, developed to invest directly back into the communities close to the project.

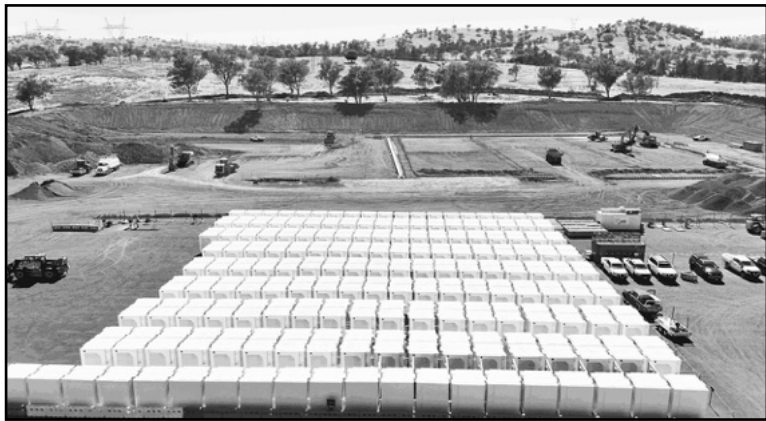
AMPYR Australia Project Director Anthony Yeates said AMPYR is committed to ensuring the Bulabul Battery delivered meaningful, long-term value for the local community.

"This Fund is designed to support local organisations doing important work, whether it's strengthening cultural connections, supporting young people, upgrading essential facilities or enhancing community wellbeing.

"We want to make sure funding decisions reflect community priorities and deliver lasting and meaningful outcomes that continue to make a difference long after construction is completed.

"The Bulabul Battery is about positive impacts, partnership and shared benefit, and this Fund is a key part of that commitment."

Eligible organisations located in or delivering services to Wellington, Geurie, Mumbil and Stuart Town are



encouraged to apply.

Projects must be "project ready" and able to begin within 12 months.

This announcement follows news that Wambal Bila, the Wellington Aboriginal community-controlled corporation, has secured a 5 per cent equity stake in the Bulabul Battery, one of the first commercial partnership and ownership arrangements of its kind in Australia's clean-energy sector.

Lions out and about

LIONS WELLINGTON presented donations to the region's schools during the schools' their annual Presentation ceremonies leading up to the Christmas break.

A member Lion was invited to each ceremony which was a delight for all local members.

It's Christmas all year at the Lions Pre-loved book shop in Warne Street as every child who comes into the shop with an adult receives a free children's book.

The shop is open Thursday to Saturday 10am to 2pm but will close for Christmas and New Year on Saturday, December 20 and re-opening Saturday, January 10.

If people are still looking for Lions Christmas Cakes and Puddings they need to hurry because stocks are running very short.

There are still a few left in the preloved book shop, and Wellington Craft Co-op in Percy Street still have stock and they don't close until Christmas Eve.

Interesting to note that the prices are the same as last year with the addition of a smaller 400g Gluten Free Cake.

Your local Lions Club will be at Christmas in the Park' on Sunday to celebrate Christmas with hot food and cold drinks, as well as giving away Australian Geographic Magazines and Children's books.

Lions wish everyone a Merry Christmas and a



Lion Graham Dickson represented Wellington Lions at the Mumbil Public School presentation afternoon.

Wool Industries call for united action to increase PIC adoption

WOOL INDUSTRIES Australia (WIA), representing the entire Australian wool supply chain, is calling on growers, classers, brokers, and selling agents to work together in a final industry-wide effort to lift Property Identification Code (PIC) uptake ahead of significant traceability requirements commencing on January 1, 2026.

From this date, a valid PIC will be required as a condition of testing for the certification of Australian Wool Testing Authority (AWTA) test results on all grower lots and interlots.

Quite simply, no PIC will mean no test certificate.

This mandate is an industry-led initiative, driven by WIA in alignment with the International Wool Textiles Organisation (IWTO) regulations, and implemented by AWTA.

Supporting strong traceability and industry resilience

WIA Chairman David Michell said having a PIC improved traceability and built industry reliance.

"A PIC is already central to Australia's livestock traceability system," he said.

"Extending its consistent use across the wool sector will significantly

strengthen national preparedness for Emergency Animal Disease (EAD) responses and enhance confidence in the origin and traceability of Australian wool throughout domestic and global supply chains."

The Australian wool industry's goal, through WIA, is to achieve PIC declaration on more than 90 per cent of Australian wool bales, ensuring the industry remains robust, trusted, and resilient in the face of future challenges.

Recognising progress and the need for a final push

Growers and their agents have already made an encouraging voluntary start in transmitting PICs with their wool on around 70pc of all lots, which is a strong foundation and clear demonstration of goodwill across the sector, however this is below the industry's target.

Therefore, a final collective push is now required to lift this to at least 90pc by January 2026.

"Failure to achieve this uplift will increase the likelihood of trade disruption across auction and private treaty markets, highlighting the importance of immediate action," Mr Michell said.



LEFT: A blast from the past at Christmas time.

Back in the early 1990s everyone got involved in Christmas festivities, even Wellington High School students who participated in Santa sign construction and distribution. Wellington businesses got involved with the Santa cutouts and had them placed on the front awing of just about every shop and business in town.

Damien Bell (crouching on the

truck tabletop) is with fellow high school students Aaron Carpenter, Brady Lang and another unidentified, who participated in the cutting out pattern project in Dubbo before transporting the Santas to Wellington for distribution.

One of the town's movers and shakers Terry Hoffman was one of the local businessmen who got themselves involved with the project.

Check out the
Wellington & District Leader
new website
Scan the QR code to view



Festive season closures at council - 2025-2026

DUBBO REGIONAL Council (DRC) facilities and services will be closed or operating to a modified schedule during the December – January festive season.

Essential services, such as waste collection, will continue as normal, while tourism and retail facilities will also operate largely as normal, with some public holiday exceptions.

During the period residents will also still be able to contact Council for assistance in emergencies by calling the on-call team on (02) 6801 4000.

Residents will be able to lodge general service requests through the DRC&ME portal through the closure period, and these service requests will be actioned when staff return in January.

Essential services:

- **Domestic Waste Collection:** No changes.
- **Waste Disposal Facilities** (Wellington, Whylandra and Transfer stations): Closed Thursday 25 December 2025.
- **Wellington and Dubbo Customer Experience Centres:** Closed from 5pm Friday 19 December 2025; reopening 9am Monday 5 January 2026.

An on-call team will be available for emergencies and residents are able to lodge service requests through DRC&ME throughout the closure period with these requests to be actioned when staff return in January.

- **Dubbo City Animal Shelter:** Closed Thursday 25 and Friday 26 December and Thursday 1 January 2026 (Open for appointments for pickups and drop offs on non-closure days between 12pm and 3pm between Saturday 20

December and Monday 5 January.

Tourism and Retail facilities:

- **Wellington and Dubbo Visitor Information Centres:** Closed 4.30pm Wednesday 24 December and reopening 8am, Saturday 27 December 2025.
- **Western Plains Cultural Centre and Creo Café:** Closed Wednesday 24 December 2024; reopening 8.30am Saturday 27 December 2025. Closed Tuesday 1 January 2026.
- **Wellington Caves:** Closed Thursday 25 December 2025.
- **Old Dubbo Gaol:** Closed Thursday 25 December 2025.
- **Dubbo Regional Botanic Garden:** Closed Wednesday 24 and Thursday 25 December 2025 and Thursday 1 January 2026.

Other facilities:

- **Wellington Civic Centre and Dubbo Regional Theatre and Convention Centre:** Closed from Monday 22 December 2025 until Monday 5 January 2026. Enquiries for funerals and wakes can be directed to the Dubbo RSL on (02) 6845 2877 or the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club on (02)6845 2877.
- **Wellington and Dubbo Libraries:** Closed from 12pm Wednesday 24 December until 10am Monday 5 January. The online library can be accessed 24/7 during this time.
- **Family Day Care:** Closed from Saturday 20 December 2025; reopening Monday 5 January 2026.

Dubbo Regional Council would like to wish everyone a happy and safe Christmas and Festive Season and a Happy New Year.

All ready for Christmas - Santa Sacks



WELLINGTON DISTRICT Hospital staff send out a re-sounding ‘Thank You’ to all who donated toys to fill Santa Sacks this Christmas.

Wellington hospital combined again with all other Western Area Health District hospitals to conduct the KISS program – Kids in need of Santa Sacks.

In Wellington toys filling up to 30 sacks have been donated to the hospital to go to the program run by Jason Owen’s ‘Doin it for Rural Aussie Kids’.

Pictured are Michelle Lang and Lisa Hodges at Wellington Hospital among the 30 sacks

filled to the brim with Christmas toys and goodies ready to be picked-up.

We tend to only think of hospital when we feel ill or involved in an accident.

And we probably don’t even think about what’s inside.

But as we get closer to Christmas, the whole atmosphere within Wellington hospital changes to an incredible festive season celebration.

It’s worth a visit just to see the colourful decorations in the hallways and departments.



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The festive season isn't always easy, and that's okay

Whether you've had a tough year or endured some recent setbacks, it's okay to pause and reach out for support.

Looking after your mental health and wellbeing doesn't mean making big changes. Often, it can start with something simple like checking in with yourself, or someone you care about.



For more information to support your mental health and wellbeing, visit www.health.nsw.gov.au/support or call the Mental Health line on 1800 011 511.





History of Walmer

By Neil Wykes OAM, Roseville, NSW. and made available from Kelvin Wykes of Wellington.

About This History

This has turned into a “selective” history of the Village of Walmer in western NSW with a bias towards the history that related to and interested Neil Wykes.

Hopefully it will encourage and help others to do more research to find out more of the early history of Walmer.

It effectively does not go beyond about 1970 as by this time the shop had closed the school had closed and the railmotor was only running three days a week and finally stopped in 1974.

When did the post office close and the telephone exchange change to automatic? The mains line electricity arrived in the area in 1961/2 and by 1970 improved roads, cars and changes in farming practices meant that the owners of farms started to move from their farms to towns to live and they no longer employed one or two families on their farms.

The research using Trove however tells a story of a very active and vibrant community from about 1900 to 1950.

Trove cuts off about 1954, so it is more difficult to source articles on community activity in the 1950’s.

Walmer appears to have become a community after the state government effectively broke up the very large pastoral leases and sold land grants starting in the late 1890’s.

I started out to find out more about my step grandfather John Albert “Jack” Wilkin for the larger history of the Forebears of Neil Wykes and Lynn Edwards and their early lives and their life together.

I later realised I knew very little about Jack Wilkin’s background.

I had always believed that he ran the Walmer Store before my parents took over the store, and this seems to be true, but it was for only a few years.

It appears that he ran the store from when Frances Wykes purchased the store in 1947 until Les & June Wykes moved into the property in 1949 and Frances transferred the property to her eldest son Les.

I decided that I needed to try to find out the history of ownership of the land on which the store was located by searching property records as well as Trove searches. This led to finding out many things about the Village of Walmer.

These have all been recorded so that the reader can get a feel for life in an area like Walmer in the first half of the 20th century.

Set out in detail is a documentation of that journey including copies of Maps and Trove articles in the Appendices.

I have a feeling from articles in the Wellington Times that the store and the shed at the back of the house which served as the Village Hall were in existence when James & Evangaline Pearson purchased the property from Lane & Sheppard in 1930, but this may or may not be correct.

I am hoping that someone may read this and decide to do further work on the history of Walmer NSW as there are many families that warrant further research and documentation of their lives.

It will be fascinating to see what other information comes to light with further work.

The Pearson Family was prominent as were the Astill, Bishop, Baird, Finch, Parkes and Taylor families.

There is some information recorded on the Wykes, Pearson, Astill, Lane/Baird, Murray, Jennings & Taylor families and I have added what I can remember of other families and names that have been gleaned from newspaper articles.

You will see that I have concentrated on families that owned property in the Parish

of Ganoo and have done limited research on the Trounce family who were in the Parish of Veech.

I have included notes from Maps that provide the Volume & Folio number for most Portions.

I have only looked up a small number of title deeds in order to find out the history of the shop.

This is largely because I have found that with my eyesight I struggle to read the digitised title records that can be accessed from the Land Registry Services LRHV website.

Hopefully someone with better sight will do more research on these records.

I have included all the documentation because I have found that if I do not then at some point, I may have to try to find it again when further information comes to light.

It is also included so anyone wanting to expand on this work knows where the information was sourced.

The searches have provided some information on the Walmer Post Office, Walmer Church, the Walmer Farmers & Settlers Association, The Walmer sporting clubs the Walmer Public School.

References to “a hall” make it fairly clear that the shed behind the Walmer Store was the Hall.

It had a polished floor which helps to confirm this belief.

The school at least after it moved in 1931 was located on land that originally was part of Karoo, the Baird family property (later Marie Morley) as was the church.

The title documents appear to make references to the school and some form of legal arrangement.

The Church however does not appear on maps of title documents from 1934.

This fits with my recollections from childhood but it may simply reflect the fact that the Church was not placed next to the school until after 1934 when the last map was prepared.

It was built in 1934 and opened in 1935.

It should be noted that Maps with a later date appear to be taken from the earlier maps.

I have always been told that the church was originally on the Baird’s property and was then moved next to the school and was later moved back to the Baird’s property.

I am not sure if this is correct. I have established that the church was opened in 1935 and was funded by donations and fundraising events such as a Walmer Picnic Day.

The Baird Family however has a clear connection with the church as Douglas Baird’s father was a Presbyterian Minister for the Hawkesbury and Douglas married into the Lane family who considered themselves to be the aristocracy according to some notes found on Mrs Samuel Lane.

The maps also included part of the road into Avelawn, Frances Wykes’ property. I have attempted to identify “Avelawn”, 178 Wykes Lane Wellington NSW 2820, but have not found a transfer to Frances (Grandmother) Wykes who I believe owned the property and it was given to her by her parents.

The road into the property and through it does appear on 1934 and 1968 maps and it goes through the property.

My childhood recollection is that this road / right of way was a major source of conflict with the “Higgins” family.

I am fairly sure that it is the Portion

number 36 on the 1934 map originally owned by Samuel Taylor and sold to Annie Strahorn who then on sold a portion to George Edward Pickford on 12 February 1925, and the balance to Robert Pickford.

Unfortunately, the new volume and Folio is not entered on the transfer note on the title. I have assumed this as the block was 640 acres and appears to be correct from the map and the fact that it was sold to George Edward Pickford, Frances’ father.

It is fascinating that in this small sample of property transaction a woman was often the owner of the land.

Names that were very familiar in our childhood appear on the 1934 map most notably Astill’s as the owner of the property on the other side of the road and Parkes Family the property on the Arthurville Road and of course the name Samuel Taylor appears quite a lot.

There are a great many Trove articles from the Wellington Times that refer to Walmer.

I have looked at many trying to find information on the shop but there are many that I have not read or even found.

One thing stands out and that is that Walmer had a very active Farmers & Settlers Association.

The names Job, Bishop and Finch appear along with Lane in the very early days.

I decided that whilst the focus for me was the shop I should also include the information I have gathered on the Village of Walmer, the school, the church and the railway station, The house where Merv Wykes and family lived plus Avelawn the Wykes family property.

Consequently, I have included work done by David Parkes about Ganoo and included information from a history of the Molong to Dubbo railway line given to me by volunteers at Dundullimal Homestead in Dubbo.

There was a Henry Wykes who is named as a Trustee of the Walmer United Church.

I have found a Henry Wykes the eldest child of James Wykes and Elizabeth Matthews.

James was the third child of James and Susan Wykes. Henry was born in 1876 and died in 1937. I have no idea where he may have lived in Walmer.

I also found something that suggested that Dave Wykes, Abels’ brother also had a property in Walmer at some point.

The Name Walmer

The village of Walmer was named after the name given to the Trounce Farm at the Wellington end of the district now known as “Walmer”.

The farm was named Walmer after The Duke of Wellington’s castle on the South East coast of England.

Walmer Castle in Deal, Walmer Kent is one of the Cinque Ports and is the official residence of the Lord Warden of the Cinque Ports. A former Australian Prime Minister Robert Menzies was made Chief Warden of the Cinque Ports by Queen Elizabeth.

The district that is now known as Walmer comprises areas that were most likely originally known as Ganoo and Walmer.

Ganoo was situated in what was known as the Parish of Ganoo in the County of Gordon in the Molong Land District.

Adjacent and a little further along the road to Wellington from the Railway crossing

was the boundary with the Land District of Wellington, and this area is the Parish of Veech in the County of Gordon.

Walmer is situated on land of the Wiradjuri Nation. I have yet to establish which of the 8 Wiradjuri Clans lived in the area that included Walmer.

It is possible it was the Dundullimal Clan (thunder).

The name Ganoo or Goonoo is Wiradjuri for plentiful water.

The Trounce family’s property is called “Walmer” and was in the Wellington Land District.

Letters to the editor of the Wellington Times in July 1923 from Mr HA Pearson (Herbert) of “Glencot” and Mr WM Strahorn who both owned property in the Parish of Ganoo argued for the name of the railway siding be called Ganoo.

This indicated that the name was clearly very contentious.

The name of the school was changed in 1904 from Ganoo to Walmer.

There are references in articles in the Wellington Times to the Ganoo school up to 1919.

The original Ganoo school, however, was most likely located in the Parish of Ganoo on land dedicated as a reserve in 1884 to be used for the Walmer Public School.

In 1908 the Walmer Post Office was run by Mr P Trounce, presumably on his property which means it was most likely a long way from the school at the Wellington end of the district.

The railway siding was originally called Ganoo but the Walmer F&S (Farmers and Settlers Association) wanted it called Walmer.

Eventually around 1930 the siding was named Walmer.

Interestingly the history of the railway line shows that just north of the Walmer siding was a loop called the Ganoo Loop.

After the railway commenced operation in May 1925 “The Village of Walmer” was based around the railway siding and the Wellington Parkes Road.

This road was originally known as Ganoo Road and is now Renshaw-McGirr Way.

The siding area included a wheat Silo completed in 1935 and the ramps for loading and unloading goods onto and from train carriages.

There were also a cattle and sheep loading yards and the fettlers sheds and the Tents for railway workers.

There were two reserves set aside for the community by the Molong Land board both in the Parish of Ganoo.

There was one at the Yeoval end of the Village near the turn off to Noonameena Road and the stock route.

The other was just over the railway level crossing opposite where the school and church were eventually located.

There was also a reserve in the county of Veech between Bishop Road and Gunners Dam Road. It appears to be what was called Smokey Camp.

There existed a Walmer Farmers & Settlers Association who appears to have been very powerful and influential based on articles published in the Wellington Times.

The articles from the Wellington Times appear in a later a section.

The Village developed following the opening of the railway line in 1925.

...To be contnued.

Coroner finds police action ‘inadequate’ in lead-up to murder-suicide

By ABC Western Plains Journalists
Lily Plass and James Paras.

A CORONER has recommended the NSW Police Commissioner amend domestic violence procedures following the murder-suicide of a couple with known history of family violence.

Deputy State Coroner Rebecca Hosking handed down her findings last Tuesday following an inquest into the deaths of 57-year-old Lynette Thompson, who was set alight inside a car in 2020, and her partner Alan Fletcher who was discovered nearby with self-inflicted injuries.

Both later died in hospital.

Magistrate Hosking found police action “inappropriate” and “inadequate” in the lead-up to the deaths.

She asked that senior officers also be given space where they can indicate the reason for an ADVO application refusal so that the submitting officer has a chance to respond.

Ms Thompson and Mr Fletcher had six children during a relationship that spanned more than four decades.

During the inquest, evidence was given of a recorded history of domestic violence between the couple dating back to 1992 and that the relationship could be on-again,

off-again.

In the 18 months prior to the murder, the findings showed Ms Thompson was seeing someone new.

“This suggests that [Ms Thompson] was focused on a new relationship,” the coroner said.

On November 8, 2020, Ms Thompson was found in a critical condition inside a burning car outside a park in Wellington, in the Central Western Slopes of NSW.

Mr Fletcher was found in a nearby backyard with severe self-inflicted injuries and died the following day at Dubbo Hospital.

Ms Thompson, who had suffered burns to 72 per cent of her body, died later that month.

The inquest determined Mr Fletcher had set Ms Thompson alight on November 8 before inflicting wounds on himself.

The couple’s children and other family members in the court and on audio-visual link were visibly upset when the findings were handed down.

“The trauma surrounding the circumstance of both your mother and father’s death is horrific,” Magistrate Hosking told the court.

The inquest highlighted a number of

issues the coroner felt were “inappropriate” or “inadequate” in police dealings with the couple.

A month prior to the murder-suicide, Mr Fletcher was bailed to the same address as Ms Thompson in Wellington, after both had been charged with drug-related offences in May 2020.

In October 2019, a cross-Apprehended Domestic Violence Order (ADVO) was rejected by a senior police officer after both alleged to have been physically assaulted by the other and signed written statements.

The inquest heard Constable Luke Robinson, a junior officer at the time, submitted a cross-ADVO, issued when both involved parties were seen as the primary aggressor.

The junior constable told the inquest that at the time he had “real fears in respect to both parties.”

Constable Robinson said he did not include those fears or prior domestic violence incidents in the application.

He said he was not aware at the time that he could correct missing information and resubmit the application if initially unsuccessful.

In a statement to the court in June

Constable Robinson said he had a conversation with Inspector Michael Smith who told him “we don’t do cross-ADVOs”.

Inspector Smith testified at the inquest that in 25 years on the job he had never applied for a cross-ADVO.

History of domestic violence

Magistrate Hosking said Inspector Smith’s rigidity of having to establish one primary aggressor “fails to take into account the realities of DV”.

The history of domestic violence between the two co-accused was not mentioned during the bail application in which they were released to the same address.

The coroner noted that had an ADVO been in place, bailing Ms Thompson and Mr Fletcher to the same address would have been flagged as an issue.

Ms Hosking made clear that even if the former couple had been bailed to different locations, it did not mean that either Mr Fletcher or Ms Thompson would be alive.

“The precise impact of the fact will remain unknown.

“However, it is a factor relevant to the relationship at the time of death.”

The ABC has contacted the NSW Police Commissioner for comment.

The History of Walmer Tougher sentences for intimate partner homicide

By Neil Wykes OAM

...From Page 6.

In November 1925 Miss Cris Pearson of “Glencot” became the Walmer Post Mistress and telephone operator.

The school reopened in 1925. The Walmer store installed a Petrol bowser in 1930, this may have also been the year it opened.

The Silos were completed in 1935 and the Walmer United Church was also opened in 1935.

THE NSW Government has passed legislation enshrining a standard non-parole period of 25 years for the murder of a current or former partner.

This is the first time in Australia a specific non-parole period for intimate partner homicide has been legislated.

Reflecting the gravity of the crime, the 25-year standard non-parole period is among the highest of any offence in NSW.

Murder carries a standard non-parole period of 20 years.

This reform represents a 25 per cent increase, aligning intimate partner murder with other offences that attract the state’s most severe sentencing standards, such as the murder of a child

or public officials acting in the course of their duties.

The murder of a current or former intimate partner is a heinous crime that causes profound harm to victims, families and communities. This legislation ensures laws reflect both the severity of these offences and their devastating impact.

In the five years to June 2025, 59 people in NSW were murdered by a current or former intimate partner – 42 of them women. This reform builds on the state government’s ongoing commitment to ensure the justice system protects victim-survivors of domestic and family violence and holds perpetrators to account.





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Public Notice

An Open Invitation
to attend the ‘Farewell’
to Father Carl McKander
on his retirement - 7pm
Saturday, 3 January
Infant De Prague Hall
Wellington.
RSVP for catering purposes
026845 2061

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington
WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church
77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church
Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
6pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month
Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Riverside Church Inc.
170 Thornton Street
Sunday: 10.00am Service
Thursday: Bible Study for Men and Women 10.30 am

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CHRISTMAS SERVICES 2025
ANGLICAN CHURCH

Christmas Eve 24th December

11am Maranatha

11pm St Johns Wellington

Christmas Day 25th December

9am St John’s Wellington

CHRISTMAS MASS TIMES
ST PATRICK’S PARISH

CHRISTMAS EVE
Wednesday 24th December
Stuart Town 5.00pm Mass
Wellington: 7.00pm

CHRISTMAS DAY
Thursday 25th December
Yeoval: 8.00am Mass
Wellington: 10.00am Mass

The Bishops Special Christmas Appeal
will be taken up at all Masses

Around the electorate with our State Member Dugald Saunders



MERRY CHRISTMAS TO ALL

AS THIS is my last column for 2025, I would like to take a moment to thank you for your support over the past year, and to wish you the very best for a wonderful Christmas and New Year.
Whether it’s a g’day at an event, an email to my office or kind words on social media, I’m really proud to represent such wonderful people from the Dubbo electorate.
My electorate office will be closed from 5pm Monday 22 December 2025 and will re-open at 9am Monday 12 January 2026.
I hope you have a lovely holiday – here’s to a bumper 2026!

Digital collection launched
Last week Dubbo Regional Council (DRC) launched ‘Reveal’ - the online cultural collections hub for the Dubbo region.
Supported by funding through Create NSW, this platform allows DRC to showcase its diverse collection of historic, artistic, paleontological, and archival materials

digitally. Users can currently access 140 records from the Western Plains Cultural Centre, Old Dubbo Gaol and Wellington Caves, which reflect not only our local heritage, but also show how our region intersects with NSW and the nation as a whole.
Check out the collection at: <https://collections.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/explore>

Workers Comp update
The NSW Nationals and Liberals have secured important improvements to the Minns Labor Government’s Workers Compensation proposals.
The outcome balances three imperatives including affordability for employers, protection for injured workers and long-term sustainability of the workers compensation scheme.
The compromise includes a legislated 18-month restriction on average premium increases, retention of the Whole Person

Impairment (WPI) thresholds and a new “Return to Work” intensive program that provides an additional year of medical benefits and income replacement.
Additionally, a replacement program to Business Connect will be developed with the successor program to have a comparable budget, informed by expert consultation.
The agreement will allow the Workers Compensation Legislation Amendment (Reform and Modernisation) Bill 2025 to pass the Upper House in February next year.

Double Demerits
Drivers are reminded that double demerit points for the Christmas Day, Boxing Day and New Year’s Day period apply from Wednesday 24 December until Sunday 4 January 2026, inclusive.
Speeding, using a mobile phone illegally,

riding without a helmet, not wearing or incorrectly wearing a seatbelt or carrying passengers not wearing or incorrectly wearing a seatbelt or restraint will see you face double demerits during the enforcement period.

Diaries now available
The highly anticipated 2026 Legal Topics for Seniors Diary is now available from my office.
A strictly limited number of diaries are available; however, it will also be available from a variety of organisations, including Legal Aid NSW, local libraries and other community groups.
To secure your copy, visit my office at 1/18 Talbragar Street Dubbo, call 6882 3577 or email dubbo@parliament.nsw.gov.au

Until next year,
Dugald

Yeoval Central School update

Shock and Sorrow at Bondi Terror Attack

Meet our 2026 School Captains!

Congratulations to Audrey, Sophia, Ethan and Lance Isaiah who were announced as 2026 captains at the Yeoval Central School Presentation Night last Wednesday.

They will be officially inducted in Term 1, 2026, at a special assembly.



Presentation Night

We would like to sincerely thank our special guests, presenters, families and community members who attended the 2026 Yeoval Central School Presentation Night held last Wednesday evening.

This annual event is a highlight of our school calendar, providing a wonderful opportunity to acknowledge and celebrate the achievements of our students across a wide range of academic, cultural and community activities.

We are incredibly grateful for the continued support from parents, carers and our wider community, as it is their encouragement and involvement that inspires our students to strive for excellence.

The success of the night was truly a team effort, and we look forward to continued collaboration in the future.

Staffing for 2026

We are pleased to announce that staffing arrangements for the 2026 school year have now been finalised.

Over the coming days, a detailed letter will be sent home to parents and carers outlining the primary and secondary class structures.

Our staffing decisions have been carefully made to best meet the educational and developmental needs of our diverse student body, ensuring a positive and supportive learning environment.

End of Term

As we approach the conclusion of Term 4, we are excited to celebrate the wonderful achievements and growth of our students throughout the year.

Today, Thursday, students will participate in a special end-of-year outing to the Dubbo Aquatic Centre, where they can enjoy a fun day of swimming and recreational activities.

This event is a chance for students and staff to come together in a relaxed and joyful setting to mark the end of another successful school year.

Additionally, we will be celebrating the primary school graduation of our Year 6 students, Xander and Narla, at a special dinner tomorrow evening at the Yeoval Bowling Club.

This milestone marks an important transition as they prepare to move into secondary education next year.

We wish Xander and Narla every success and happiness as they take this next step in their educational journey, and we look forward to watching them continue to thrive.

Wishing everyone a restful holiday period. We look forward to students returning on Monday 2 February 2026.

OUR COUNTRY is in shock at the horrific and appalling terrorist attack at Bondi on Sunday.

At the time of writing, 15 innocent lives have been lost, including a 10-year-old girl, while a further 42 people are being treated in hospital.

All our thoughts are with those who have lost loved ones and the injured and wounded in this deeply tragic attack.

Our communities offer our sincere condolences to them.

Our heartfelt thanks to all the police, first responders and members of the public who assisted, including those who risked their own lives to save others.

It was an incredibly brave act of heroism by civilian Ahmed al Ahmed, who tackled and disarmed one of the gunmen.

The 43-year-old father of two children from Sutherland in Sydney’s south did not hesitate to intervene. Other bystanders also acted with extreme heroism and bravery to neutralise the gunmen.

We stand in unity and solidarity with Australia’s Jewish community in condemning this senseless murder and violence.

Hate must never prevail.

Win for ‘people power’ on Merotherie environmental vandalism

The united outrage of the Central West community has been heard by the Federal Environment Minister Murray Watt who has referred the Merotherie Road incident to his department’s Compliance and Enforcement branch.



This is a crucial win for people power.

The branch will now investigate for any breach of the federal law, the Environment Protection and Biodiversity Conservation Act (EPBC Act).

Groups, local government, businesses and landholders all demanded an official Inquiry into the incident in late October when hundreds of native trees were bulldozed during bird nesting season, killing, injuring and orphaning large numbers of baby birds and other native animals.

The centuries-old native wildlife corridor north of



Gulgong was wiped out by the NSW Government-owned company EnergyCo as part of construction of power lines for the Central West Orana Renewable Energy Zone.

The NSW Government is refusing to take any responsibility, despite EnergyCo’s contracted workers admitting to Mudgee wildlife carers that it should never have happened.

The NSW Government cannot be trusted to investigate itself, so it’s important that the Federal Government investigates the legality of this



environmental vandalism.

The Rylstone District Environment Society, supported by the Mid-Western Regional Council, have set out a strong case of alleged breaches of federal law. I back this 100 per cent.

Let’s now see where this investigation goes.



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld



IT WAS 2006 when Facebook first introduced its minimum user age of 13.

All of my (now adult) children counted down to their 15th birthday with the same anticipation most kids reserve for getting their L-plates.

What amused me then - and concerns me now - was that many of their classmates were already online.

As birthday notifications started popping up on their new feed, it turned out some kids in the same year at school were apparently several years older. Of course, they weren’t. Someone had simply typed in a more “convenient” date of birth to get past the rudimentary age verification.

Whether that was done with a parent’s blessing or ignorance remains a mystery, but the deed was done.

Fast-forward to today, and that casual bending of the rules doesn’t stand a chance.

Australia has introduced a world-first under-16 social media ban, and it’s not the sort of rule parents can quietly override at home like the occasional sip of wine at a family barbecue.

This new law takes the decision entirely out of parental hands. “But my child is very mature,” some parents say - and they may well be right - but that isn’t part of the equation anymore.

Platforms must take steps to block under-16s or risk fines up to \$49.5 million.

For many parents, this moment brings mixed emotions. Social media has long been the modern town square where kids share jokes, follow sporting heroes, and sometimes learn things they’re not quite ready for.

Yet it has also become the place where algorithms nudge young brains toward addictive engagement, where comparison culture gnaws at self-esteem, and where the world’s worst content is always just a few clicks away.

The ban applies to the biggest players in the online world. Accounts for popular apps have begun disappearing as companies roll out their age-verification systems.

They include tools ranging from analysing behaviour patterns to ID checks. None of these tools is foolproof, and every system will be poked and prodded by teenagers eager to outsmart it.

We all remember being 15 - resourceful, inventive, and certain we knew more than the adults.

Parents, meanwhile, are left navigating the emotional fallout. Kids who have grown up with a digital social life may feel cut off. For those in regional areas, whose online communities helped bridge physical distance, the impact may be even sharper.

This is where families will need to invest in alternative connections before resentment and withdrawal creep in. A simple phone call with a friend, more in-person hangouts, or even rediscovering hobbies that don’t need a screen can help fill the gap.

This moment also gives families a rare chance to reset their digital habits.

Many households have sleepwalked into a world where social media is just part of the daily wallpaper. Now there’s an opportunity - perhaps an uncomfortable one - to ask bigger questions.

What role should technology actually play in childhood? How can we teach digital literacy without relying on platforms designed around engagement rather than wellbeing? With the external pressure of the ban, families can finally design their own internal rules rather than wrestling with tech giants for influence.

No law will perfectly balance safety, freedom, connection, and independence. This one certainly won’t please everyone, and we’ll be debating its impacts for years.

But it does force a conversation that was long overdue. Closing the gates may protect our kids or frustrate them or maybe just postpone the inevitable.

The real question now is how we help our kids grow into digital adults once the door finally opens at 16.

I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first 10 e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, get a freebie!



Wellington Public School Year 6 Farewell



Environment Bill - Summary

PART OF a package of 7 bills to implement the recommendations of the *2020 Independent Review of the Environment Protection and Biodiversity Conservation Act 1999* (the Samuel Review), the bill amends the *Environment Protection and Biodiversity Conservation Act 1999* to: streamline the assessment and approvals process; update provisions relating to accreditation and bilateral agreements; provide for bioregional plans; provide a framework for the Minister to make, vary and revoke national environmental standards; make it clear that projects with unacceptable impacts on nationally protected matters can no longer be approved; prevent a

project being approved unless all residual significant impacts of the action on nationally protected matters have been compensated to a net gain; provide a mechanism for projects that are in the national interest to be approved even if they do not meet certain requirements; allow conditions to be attached to taking an action covered by a national interest exemption; amend provisions relating to reconsiderations; update provisions relating to conservation planning and heritage; update compliance and enforcement powers; and make administrative amendments. Also makes consequential amendments to 11 other Acts.

Chaffey pans environment Bill

LABOR AND the Greens cooked up a dirty deal to push through changes to the Environment Protection and Biodiversity Conservation Act in the final moments of Parliament for 2025, says Federal Member for Parkes, Jamie Chaffey. “This last-minute pact will have implications that will be felt throughout the electorate of Parkes and far beyond, causing significant problems for councils, for farmers, for miners, for forestry, for the

construction industry and for every-day Australian families,” he said. “It will impact on jobs, productivity and investment.” Mr Chaffey said the way to approach the protection of our landscape was not to give in to the Greens, but to consider all the implications and the consequences of these reforms. “Not only is this a dark day for farmers and industry, but it may leave Australians in the dark.”

Dubbo saleyards draft plan now for public exhibition

DRAFT DUBBO Saleyards Master Plan was endorsed by Council during the December Ordinary Council meeting last week. The Dubbo Regional Livestock Markets master plan will now be on public exhibition for a minimum period of 28 days in 2026 from

28/01/2026 until 25/02/2026. A further report will be provided to Council following this period. Mayor Josh Black said the future looked bright and encourages all people that transact through the Dubbo Saleyards to have a look and provide feedback on the designs.

New push for renewable protections

NSW FARMERS say legal protections for farmers hosting renewables are a logical next step following the release of a new framework for recommissioning wind and solar projects. The Clean Energy Council has launched a new national framework to guide the decommissioning of old renewable installations on farms across the nation. While the framework wasn’t enshrined in law, NSW Farmers’ Energy Taskforce Chair Reg Kidd said work to ensure developers took full responsibility for decommissioning renewables was long overdue. “Energy developers should be required to pay a bond to cover the costs of decommissioning the projects they have built, so farmers aren’t left to pay the astronomical costs of cleaning up what’s left behind,” Mr Kidd said. “Many farmers were pressured into signing contracts that are unclear as to who has to remove this infrastructure at the end of its life,

and if developers disappear or run out of cash, then that’s just another risk that could leave farmers footing the cleanup bill. “If you put it up, you take it down – that’s just common sense, but right now, there’s no guarantee that’s what will happen.” As well as legal protections to ensure developers were liable for the decommissioning of their renewable projects, Mr Kidd said it was vital developers also took responsibility for the complete rehabilitation of the land on which their projects were built. “The clean-up costs of some of these projects are well into the millions, and developers must be prepared to pay to decommission these projects properly,” Mr Kidd said. “We can’t afford for these installations to leave scars across our landscape when we need to care for our environment, so we can use it to feed and clothe the people we also power.”

It's a proven fact - newspaper advertisements get results

Farmers welcome speed limit support

NSW FARMERS president Xavier Martin has welcomed the state government’s commonsense response to the federal government’s push to slash rural speed limits. Mr Martin said the proposal to cut speed limits on country roads to 80km/h was a “straw man” solution for road safety, and serious investment in regional roads and bridges was needed to solve the problem. “Band aid solutions won’t fix the problem of crumbling roads and bridges, or deal with the growing road toll here in the regions,” Mr Martin said. “Fixing the real driver of road trauma – that is, our ruined roads – is what will make a real difference. “We need to get people home safely each day, and farmers need to be able to get their food and fibre to market safely as well.” NSW Regional Transport and

Roads Minister Jenny Aitchison made it “very, very clear... (that), the NSW Government does not support blanket speed zone reviews across NSW.” Mr Martin said safe, properly maintained roads were critical to safety, but so too were efficient, connected rail networks to take pressure off rural and regional roads. “Slowing us all down is simply a straw man solution, and if they’re going to ignore the real problems at play, we’ll never reduce our road toll,” Mr Martin said. “If you look down the track, we’ll all be crawling along while fresh food rots in the truck, all because governments no longer prioritise proper road repair and maintenance. “It’s not the speed limits that are the problem – they’ve been set for decades – it’s the fact that our roads aren’t as safe as they used to be.”

Victory on virtual fencing

NEWS VIRTUAL fencing has been legalised for cattle in NSW has farmers celebrating. A new regulation has been introduced by the NSW Government to allow for the use of technology in an exciting step forward for beef and dairy farmers across the state. “This technology has been a game changer not just in other parts of Australia, but around the globe, and it’s high time we got on board,” NSW Farmers’ Animal Welfare Committee Chair Rob McIntosh said. “This technology gives us flexibility we’ve never had before – we can graze and move stock without building kilometres of fences and laneways, and we can also easily move these virtual fences to help manage our livestock and our land. “From reducing ongoing fencing and

maintenance costs to protecting biodiversity, limiting stock handling, and increasing monitoring and grazing accuracy, the benefits of this technology are endless – and we can’t wait to start using it.” Mr McIntosh said it was positive to see the Minns Government had created practical, state-specific settings to guide the use of the technology in NSW, following strong advocacy from the state’s peak farm body. “The rules had to reflect the needs of producers, and it’s great to see our government listen to us on this,” Mr McIntosh said. “This new technology provides a whole new tool to innovate and improve productivity on farm – and we’re so excited to use it to help feed the future.”

Right road, right category: State government rewrites the rules for roads management

THE STATE Government is rewriting the framework that determines road management in NSW, announcing a modern road recategorisation system that provides councils with certainty over who will manage and maintain different roads, allowing for more targeted investment where communities need it most. Road recategorisation is the process used to decide whether a road should be managed as a State, Regional or Local road. This system determines who maintains it, who funds it and how it fits into the broader transport network. The unfair, outdated approach created long backlogs and increased pressure on local councils, who manage around 90 per cent of the state’s road network and continue to face huge challenges from climate change, worsening weather events, rising construction costs and a growing workload after repeated natural disasters. The new road recategorisation framework puts evidence ahead of politics, replacing an ad-hoc political approach with a clearer, fairer and more responsive model that focuses on how a road functions within the network. The new framework includes: * Clear statewide criteria to support consistent, needs-based decision making; * An always-open application pathway, replacing decade-long review cycles; * A new online self-assessment data tool to help councils understand early whether a proposal is likely to meet the criteria, reducing administrative burdens

* Prioritisation for roads that unlock housing, freight efficiency, resilience and major infrastructure delivery. This is a major reform that will put the right roads in the right category, cutting red tape, reducing duplication and improving how maintenance and investment are delivered across the network. It won’t fix every challenge at once, but it’s a strong step forward, according to the government. With the portal now live, local councils and road managers will be able to put forward proposals for recategorisation. Reviews of the system and processes will be conducted at three months, six months and then annually to refine the model.

Merry Christmas!

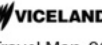
Wishing you a peaceful Christmas and a Happy New Year! May this holiday season be filled with plenty of love, laughter, and joy.

Dugald Saunders MEMBER FOR THE DUBBO ELECTORATE

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Authorised by Dugald Saunders MP, 1/18 Talbragar Street Dubbo NSW 2830. Funded using Parliamentary entitlements.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 News. 12.30 A Dog's World With Tony Armstrong. Final. 1.25 Gardening Australia: Christmas Special. 2.25 Nigella's Cook, Eat, Repeat: Christmas Special. 3.25 Long Lost Family. Final. 4.15 Extraordinary Escapes: Christmas Special. 5.00 Antiques Roadshow. 6.00 Grand Designs Australia. Final. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Spicks And Specks. Final. 8.00 Portrait Artist Of The Year. Final. 8.50 Return To Paradise. Final. 9.50 When The War Is Over. Final. 10.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 The Ashes: The Lunch Break. 1.10 Cricket. The Ashes. Third Test. Australia v England. Day 5. Afternoon session. 3.10 The Ashes: Tea Break. 3.30 Cricket. The Ashes. Third Test. Australia v England. Day 5. Evening session. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 Cricket. Big Bash League. Match 8. Melbourne Renegades v Hobart Hurricanes. 10.30 Unfiltered: Cricket. 11.00 7NEWS Spotlight. 12.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Hello SA. 6.30 A Current Affair. 7.00 Weekend Today. 10.00 Cross Court. 10.30 GolfBarons. 11.00 Fishing Australia. 11.30 Explore TV. 12.00 Find My Beach House Australia. 12.30 MOVIE: The Most Colorful Time Of The Year. (2022) 2.10 MOVIE: Destination Christmas. (2022) 4.00 Great Getaways. 5.00 9News First At Five. 5.30 RBT. 6.00 9News Sunday. 7.00 Christmas With Delta. 8.30 MOVIE: Vacation. (2015) Ed Helms, Christina Applegate, Chris Hemsworth. 10.30 Red Eye. 11.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Intrepid Adventures. 8.30 What's Up Down Under. 9.00 Australia By Design: Architecture. 9.30 Key Ingredient. 10.00 Farm To Fork. 10.30 The Dog Hospital With Graeme Hall. 11.30 Pooches At Play. 12.00 The Dog Academy. 1.00 Deal Or No Deal. 1.30 Lingo. 2.30 Basketball. NBL. Round 13. Tasmania JackJumpers v Perth Wildcats. 4.30 Deal Or No Deal. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 The Dog House Australia. 7.00 Selling Houses Australia. 8.00 The Imposter. New. 10.00 FBI. 12.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 1.00 Speedweek. 3.00 Figure Skating. ISU Grand Prix 4. H'lights. 5.30 Hotel Chocolat At Christmas. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Cleopatra: Cracking The Enigma. 8.30 Ken Burns' The American Revolution. 10.35 Mayhem: Secret Lives Of Georgian Kings. 11.30 Australian Fashion Past, Present, Future. 12.35 Empires Of New York. 3.05 Growing A Greener World. 4.05 Rediscover Victoria. 4.30 Bamay. 5.00 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Harry's Practice. 1.30 Medical Emergency. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 Christmas With The Salvos. 3.00 Hornby: A Model Empire. 4.00 Escape To The Country. 7.00 Greatest Escapes To The Country. 7.45 Mrs Brown's Boys. 8.30 Vera. 10.30 Murdoch Mysteries. 11.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Tackling Australia. 2.30 Merv Hughes Fishing. 3.00 Duck Dynasty. 4.00 Mt Hutt Rescue. 5.00 Counting Cars. 6.00 Border Security: International. 6.30 Border Security: America's Front Line. 7.00 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 8.30 MOVIE: 1917. (2019) 10.45 MOVIE: 71. (2014) 12.55 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Animals Make You Laugh Out Loud. 12.00 Sean's Kitchen. 1.00 Zumbo's Just Desserts. 3.30 Dr Harry's Animal Encounters. 4.30 Dog Patrol. 5.30 The Conners. 6.30 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. 7.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Reel Action. 8.30 Pooches At Play. 9.30 Camper Deals. 1.00 Pat Callinan's 4x4 Adventures. 11.00 JAG. 4.00 IFISH. 4.30 Basketball. NBL. Round 13. Sydney Kings v Cairns Taipans. 6.30 JAG. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Blue Bloods. 12.15 48 Hours. 1.15 Home Shopping.	 6.00 Deal Or No Deal. 8.00 Frasier. 10.00 Ridiculousness. 11.00 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 2.00 Ridiculousness. 3.00 Frasier. 4.00 Friends. 6.30 The Big Bang Theory. 9.35 Frasier. 10.30 Ridiculousness. 11.30 South Park. 12.30 Home Shopping. 1.30 South Park. 2.30 Home Shopping.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.40 Heartbreak High. 3.35 A Bite To Eat. 4.05 Would I Lie To You At Christmas? 4.40 MythBusters. 5.30 Car S.O.S. 6.15 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 7.05 Spicks And Specks. 7.35 QI. 8.05 The Piano UK. 9.00 Lucy Worsley: Agatha Christie Mystery Queen. Final. 10.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.45 Gardening Australia Junior. 5.10 Piney: The Lonesome Pine. 5.35 Peter Rabbit. 6.10 PJ Masks. 6.30 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.50 Andy And The Band. 7.05 Phipenguins. 7.30 MOVIE: Paddington. (2014) 9.00 A (Very) Musical Christmas. 10.30 Fresh Off The Boat. 10.55 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Heywire. 3.00 News. 3.30 That Pacific Sports Show. 4.00 News. 4.30 Landline. 5.00 News. 5.30 Regional Roundup. 6.00 Evening News. 6.30 The Pacific. 7.00 News. 7.30 Back Roads. 8.00 News Tonight. 8.30 If You're Listening. 9.00 Nightly News. 9.25 Foreign Correspondent. 10.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 My Favorite Martian. 10.30 The Avengers. 11.40 MOVIE: Attack On The Iron Coast. (1968) 1.35 MOVIE: Sabata. (1969) 3.45 MOVIE: The Train. (1964) 6.30 M*A*S*H. 8.30 MOVIE: Licence To Kill. (1989) Timothy Dalton, Carey Lowell, Robert Davi. 11.15 Mrs Sidhu Investigates. 1.15 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.40 Jeopardy! 4.45 WorldWatch. 5.45 Icons Unearthed: The Lord Of The Rings. 6.40 Abandoned Engineering. 8.30 Miracles. 9.50 Liaison. 10.50 Myths: The Greatest Mysteries Of Humanity. 12.50 Am I Being Unreasonable? 2.50 NHK World English News. 5.00 Al Jazeera Newshour.

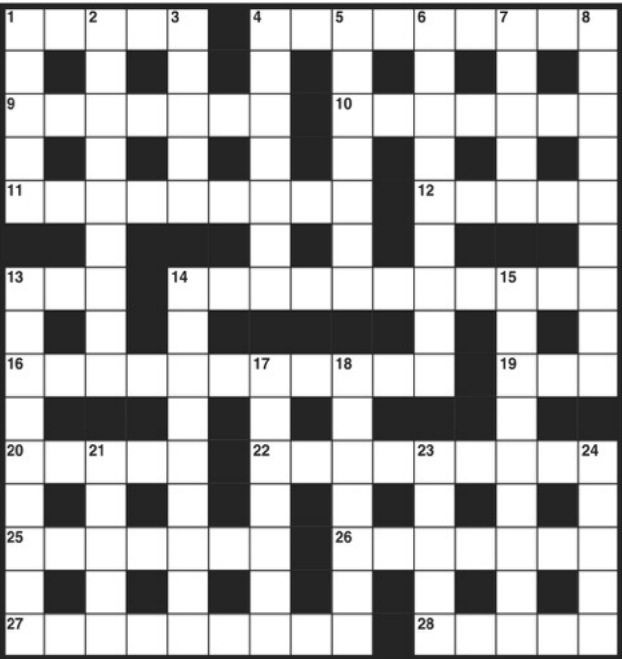
 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Ningaloo Nyinggulu. Final. 2.00 Death In Paradise. 3.00 QI. 3.30 Nigella Bites. 3.55 Grand Designs New Zealand. 4.40 Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz Kids. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 I Was Actually There. 8.00 MOVIE: Songs Inside. (2024) Nancy Bates. 9.30 MOVIE: Girls Can't Surf. (2020) Layne Beachley. 11.15 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. 11.45 Late Programs.	 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show Summer Series. Return. 12.00 MOVIE: Christmas In Pine Valley. (2022) Kristina Cole. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Cricket. Big Bash League. Match 9. Sydney Thunder v Brisbane Heat. 10.30 Big Bash League Post-Match. 11.00 Chicago Fire. 12.00 Girlfriends' Guide To Divorce. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.	 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra Summer. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 MOVIE: Just Like A Christmas Movie. (2023) 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 5.00 Tipping Point Australia. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Travel Guides. 8.40 MOVIE: Raiders Of The Lost Ark. (1981) Harrison Ford, Karen Allen, John Rhys-Davies. 11.00 Sight Unseen. 11.50 Tipping Point. 12.40 Pointless. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Global Shop. 3.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Ent. Tonight. 6.30 GCBC. 7.00 Everyday Gourmet. 7.30 Farm To Fork. 8.00 Bold. 8.30 Deal Or No Deal. 9.00 Lingo. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.30 Jamie's One-Pan Christmas. 11.30 My Market Kitchen. 12.00 Farm To Fork. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 Deal Or No Deal. 1.30 MOVIE: The SpongeBob SquarePants Movie. (2004) 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 Bondi Rescue. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.30 Love It Or List It Australia. 8.40 The Imposter. Final. 10.40 NCIS. 12.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.10 WorldWatch. 2.00 Amazon: The Lost World. 3.05 Going Places. 3.45 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.15 Westminster Abbey: Behind Closed Doors. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Secrets Of The Tasmanian Tiger. 8.30 Never Mind The Buzzcocks Christmas. 9.25 Jimmy Carr's I Literally Just Told You. 10.20 The 2010s. 11.50 The Man Who Died. 12.40 Culprits. 2.45 Pagan Peak. 3.35 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Hornby: A Model Empire. 2.00 Weekender. 2.30 Hornby: A Model Empire. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Doc Martin. 8.30 Endeavour. 10.30 Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. 11.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Motor Racing. National Drag Racing C'ship. Top Fuel C'ship. Replay. 3.30 Billy The Exterminator. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Outback Opal Hunters. 9.30 Aussie Salvage Squad. 10.30 The Mightiest. 11.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 It's Academic. 7.30 Get Arty. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 My Kitchen Rules. 11.50 Ultimate Tag. 3.00 Baking It. 4.00 The Goldbergs. 4.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 9.30 Bones. 11.30 CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. 12.30 Grimm. 3.00 Covert Affairs.	 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Reel Action. 8.30 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 9.00 The Living Room. 10.00 JAG. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 The Dog House. 2.30 JAG. 4.30 The Living Room. 5.30 JAG. 7.30 NCIS. 8.30 Blue Bloods. 10.20 Fire Country. 12.15 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.30 Deal Or No Deal. 12.00 Taskmaster Australia. 1.00 Ridiculousness. 2.00 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 3.00 Becker. 3.30 Frasier. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.00 Becker. 5.30 Frasier. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.40 A Bite To Eat. 4.05 Would I Lie To You At Christmas? 4.40 MythBusters. 5.30 Car S.O.S. 6.15 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 7.05 House Of Games. 7.35 QI Christmas Special. 8.05 Would I Lie To You? 8.35 Penn & Teller: Fool Us. 9.20 Whose Line Is It Anyway? 9.40 Late Programs.	 6.00 Kids' Programs. 3.40 Fizzy And Suds. 4.10 Andy's Safari Adventures. 4.25 Mojo Swoptops. 5.30 Peter Rabbit. 6.05 PJ Masks. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.55 Tiddler. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Operation Ouch! 8.30 TKO: Total Knock Out. 9.15 The Crystal Maze. 10.00 Merlin. 10.45 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Compass. 3.00 News. 4.30 Culture By Design. 5.00 ABC News Summer. 6.00 ABC Evening News. 6.35 If You're Listening. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 Back Roads. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.30 Australian Story. 9.00 ABC News Summer. 9.30 Foreign Correspondent. 10.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 MOVIE: Shalako. (1968) 3.20 Antiques Roadshow. 3.50 MOVIE: Double Holiday. (2019) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Death In Paradise. 8.40 MOVIE: GoldenEye. (1995) Pierce Brosnan, Sean Bean. 11.30 Shakespeare And Hathaway. 12.20 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.50 WorldWatch. 5.45 Travel Man: 96 Hours In Iceland. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 I Am Luke Perry. 10.05 The Billionaires Who Made Our World. 11.05 Question Team. 11.55 Django. 12.55 Love Around The World. 2.20 NHK World English News. 5.00 Al Jazeera Newshour.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 9.30 Nigella's Christmas Kitchen. 10.00 The Art Of... 10.30 Death In Paradise. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Killer Whale: Australia's Megapod. 2.00 Death In Paradise. 3.00 QI. 3.35 Nigella Bites. 4.00 Grand Designs New Zealand. 4.45 Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz Kids. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 The Piano UK. 8.25 The Piano UK: The Incredibly Talented Lucy. 9.25 The Assembly. 10.55 Escaping Utopia. 11.55 Late Programs.	 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show Summer Series. 12.00 MOVIE: Candy Cane Candidate. (2021) Jacky Lai. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Cricket. Big Bash League. Match 10. Adelaide Strikers v Melbourne Stars. 10.30 Seven's Cricket: The Spin. 11.15 Lopez Vs. Lopez. 12.15 Miniseries: London Spy. 1.30 Travel Oz. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.	 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra Summer. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 MOVIE: 12 Dares Of Christmas. (2023) 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 5.00 Tipping Point Australia. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Taronga: Who's Who In The Zoo. 8.30 Jamie Durie's Future House. 9.35 Beyond The Build. 10.35 Wild Cards. 11.30 La Brea. 12.15 Tipping Point. 1.05 Cross Court. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. 3.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Jamie's Christmas Shortcuts. 11.30 My Market Kitchen. 12.00 Farm To Fork. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. 2.00 Taskmaster Australia. 3.00 Deal Or No Deal. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 Bondi Rescue. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.30 The Dog House Australia. 8.30 MOVIE: The First Wives Club. (1996) Goldie Hawn, Bette Midler, Diane Keaton. 10.35 Mariah Carey: Merry Christmas To All. 12.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 Darcey Bussell's Royal Road Trip. 3.05 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 3.40 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.10 Westminster Abbey: Behind Closed Doors. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Great British Railway Journeys. 8.30 Who Do You Think You Are? 9.40 Australia In Colour. 10.40 The 2010s. 11.30 Families Like Ours. 12.30 De Gaulle. 2.30 Nordland 99. 3.00 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Creek To Coast. 2.30 Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Call The Midwife. 8.45 Judge John Deed. 10.45 Miniseries: Without Sin. 11.45 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Storage Wars. 11.30 American Pickers. 12.30 Pawn Stars. 1.30 Outback Opal Hunters. 3.30 Billy The Exterminator. 4.00 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Outback Truckers. 9.30 Railroad Australia. 10.30 Ice Road Truckers. 11.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 It's Academic. 7.30 Get Arty. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Food Dude. 10.30 My Kitchen Rules. 12.00 Ultimate Tag. 3.00 Baking It. 4.00 The Goldbergs. 4.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. 9.30 CSI: Miami. 11.30 CSI: New York. 12.30 Grimm. 3.00 Covert Affairs.	 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Escape Fishing With ET. 9.00 The Living Room. 10.00 JAG. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. 2.30 JAG. 4.30 The Living Room. 5.30 JAG. 7.30 NCIS. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.20 Fire Country. 12.15 48 Hours. 1.15 Home Shopping.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.30 Deal Or No Deal. 12.00 Taskmaster Australia. 1.00 Ridiculousness. 2.00 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 3.00 Becker. 3.30 Frasier. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.00 Becker. 5.30 Frasier. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 ER. 2.45 Heartbreak High. 3.35 Nigella's Christmas Kitchen. 4.05 Would I Lie To You? 4.40 MythBusters. 5.30 Car S.O.S. 6.15 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 7.05 House Of Games. 7.35 QI. 8.05 Would I Lie To You At Christmas? 8.35 Fisk. 9.35 Spooks. 10.30 Late Programs.	 6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.25 Mojo Swoptops. 4.50 Bluey. 5.30 Peter Rabbit. 6.05 PJ Masks Power Heroes. 6.30 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 6.50 Stick Man. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Operation Ouch! 8.30 Animals Up Close With Bertie Gregory. 9.10 Super Shark Highway. 10.00 Merlin. 10.45 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Compass. 3.00 News. 4.30 Culture By Design. 5.00 ABC News Summer. 6.00 ABC Evening News. 6.35 If You're Listening. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 Back Roads. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.30 Australian Story. 9.00 ABC News Summer. 9.30 Foreign Correspondent. 10.00 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.20 Antiques Roadshow. 3.50 MOVIE: Welcome To Christmas. (2018) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 New Tricks. 8.40 MOVIE: Tomorrow Never Dies. (1997) Pierce Brosnan, Michelle Yeoh. 11.05 Major Crimes. 12.05 Late Programs.	 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.15 Heroines. 3.45 WorldWatch. 5.45 Travel Man: 96 Hours In Jordan. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 Our Guy In Vietnam. 10.20 Hoarders. 11.15 Dark Side Of The Ring. 12.10 Bad Education. 1.20 Count Abdulla. 2.10 NHK World English News. 5.00 Al Jazeera Newshour.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 The Piano UK. 1.55 Death In Paradise. 2.55 Would I Lie To You? 3.30 Nigella Bites. 3.55 Grand Designs New Zealand. <
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CROSSWORD

No. 154



- ACROSS**

1 Looks for (5)

4 Pathological self-admirer (9)

9 Contain (7)

10 Instrument for crushing material into small pieces (7)
- 11 Subtle change by degrees (9)

12 US state (5)

13 Monopolist (3)

14 Bug poison (11)

16 Tools (11)

19 Long, slippery fish (3)

- 20 Cavalry sword (5)
- 22 Charity (9)
- 25 Print process
- 26 Drank (7)
- 27 Dangled (9)
- 28 Unkempt (5)
- DOWN**
- 1 Throw (5)
- 2 Giving something and receiving another (9)
- 3 Aqualung (5)
- 4 Foes (7)
- 5 Natural (7)
- 6 Talents (9)
- 7 Country (5)
- 8 Relating to the body (9)
- 13 Female religious leader (9)
- 14 From Israel (9)
- 15 Beyond words, indescribable (9)
- 17 Coped (7)
- 18 Cared for (7)
- 21 Dollars (colloq) (5)
- 23 Puzzle (5)
- 24 Currently (5)

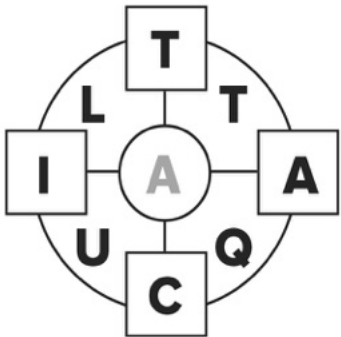


9-LETTER

No. 154

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
- 8 words: Good
- 12 words: Very good
- 17 words: Excellent

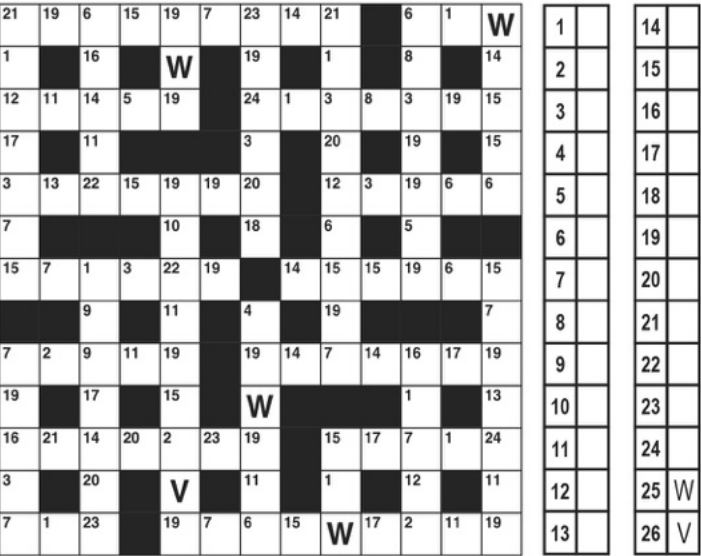


acquit, ACQUITTAL, actual, alt, aqua, aqueduct, attic, laic, qual, tactical, tact, tactful, tail, tale, tale, taut

CODEWORD

No. 104

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?



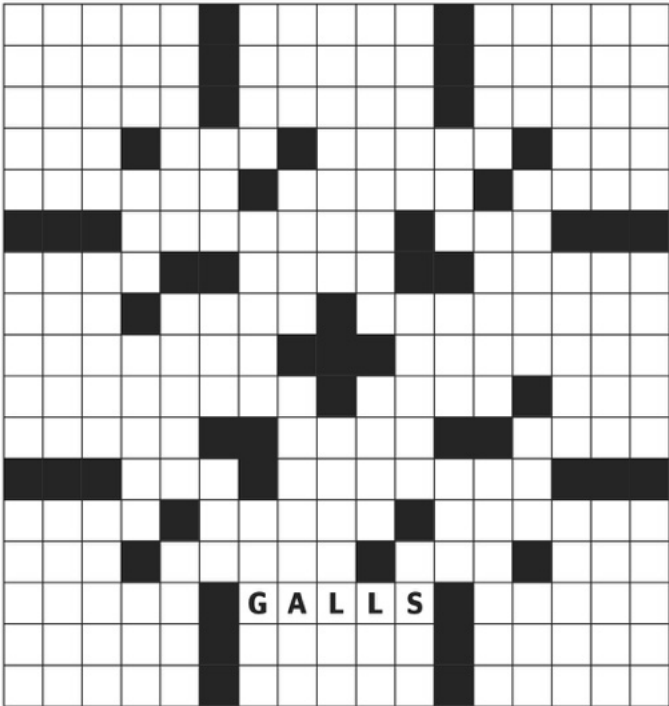
SOLUTIONS: 1=O, 2=U, 3=J, 4=I, 5=Z, 6=S, 7=R, 8=A, 9=Q, 10=F, 11=L, 12=G, 13=M, 14=A, 15=T, 16=C, 17=H, 18=Y, 19=K, 20=N, 21=V, 22=P, 23=D, 24=B

WORDFIT

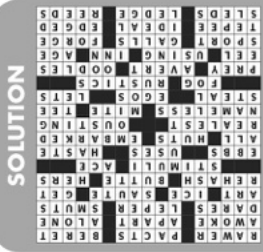
No. 064

- 3 LETTERS**
- ACE
- AGE
- ALL
- APE
- ART
- ASS
- BUT
- CHI
- EEL
- EKE
- ELM
- FOG
- GAS
- GET
- ICE
- INN
- ION
- LAG
- LSD
- ODE
- RED
- TEA
- TEE
- USE
- 5 LETTERS**
- ALONE
- APART
- AVERT
- AWARE
- AWOKE
- BERET
- BLAME
- BLEAT
- BUTTE
- CHASE
- DARES
- EARNs
- EDGED
- EDGES
- EGGED
- ELOPE
- ENTER
- FORGE
- GALLS
- HASTE
- HEART
- HELLO
- IDEAL
- LARGE
- LEAFY
- LEDGE
- LEPER
- MOIST
- MUTTS
- PACTS
- PESTS
- RADAR
- RAWER

- 4 LETTERS**
- BASE
- BUSS
- EBBS
- EGOS
- HERS
- HUTS
- ISLE
- LETS
- MITE
- MOST
- PALE
- PREY
- USES
- UTES
- 6 LETTERS**
- REEDS
- REPEL
- ROUGE
- SAUTE
- SEEDS
- SKITE
- SLEDS
- SMUTS
- SPORT
- STEAL
- STRUT
- TENET
- TEPEE
- TESTS
- USING



- 8 LETTERS**
- EMBARKED
- NAMELESS
- SERENADE
- TREATISE
- 7 LETTERS**
- CAPSULE
- GURGLED
- OUSTING
- REALEST
- RUSTICS
- STIMULI
- 6 LETTERS**
- CONFER
- OODLES
- REHASH
- RESIST
- 5 LETTERS**
- WORTH
- VIGIL

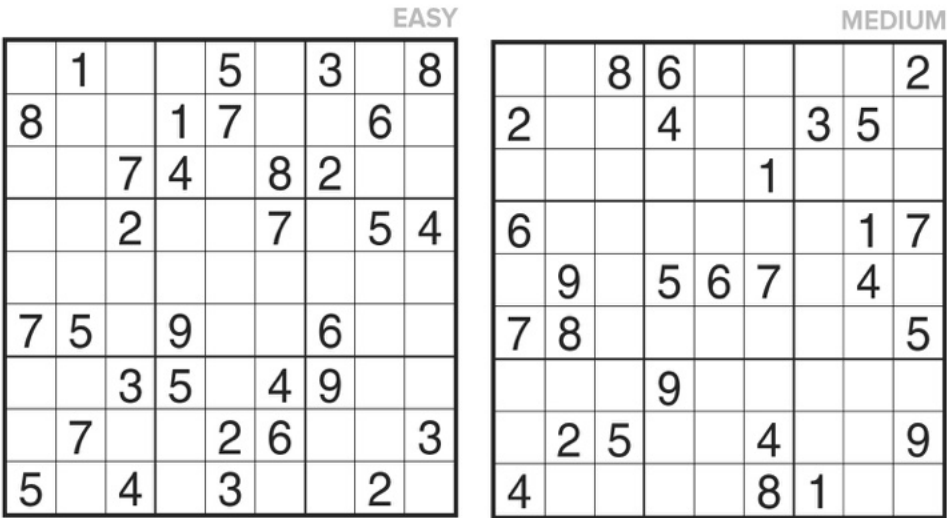


PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © **pagemasters.**

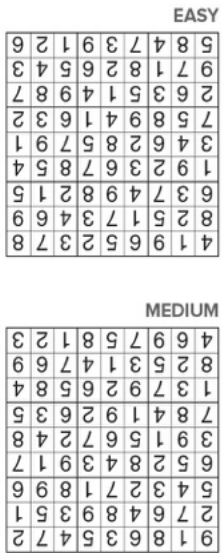
SUDOKU

No. 154

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

- What is the capital of Bangladesh?
- Scott Owen plays double bass for which Australian rock band?
- The word 'cromulent' was coined on which TV show?
- Who is captain of the North Melbourne AFLW team?
- In what movie does Clive Owen (pictured) play a carrot-eating drifter named Smith?
- US artist Grant Wood completed which painting in 1930?
- Which former model writes the Makedde Vanderwall and Pandora English book series?
- What are the two different types of lift in Olympic weightlifting competitions?
- The kip is the currency of which Southeast Asian country?
- Which Australian children's author wrote the best-selling book *The Day My Bum Went Psycho*?



ANSWERS: 1. Dhaka 2. The Living End 3. The Simpsons 4. Jasmine Garner 5. Shoot 'Em Up 6. American Gothic 7. Tara Moss 8. The snatch and the clean and jerk 9. Laos 10. Andy Griffiths

WORD SEARCH

No. 064

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ABS
- ACTIVE
- AEROBICS
- ATHLETE
- BICEPS
- BOOTCAMP
- BOXING
- BURPEE
- CIRCUIT
- COACH
- CRUNCH
- CYCLE
- ELECTROLYTES
- ENDURANCE
- ENERGY
- HIIT
- LUNGE
- NUTRITION
- PERSPIRATION
- PLANK
- PUNCH BAG
- PUSH UP
- ROWING
- SIT UP
- SQUAT
- STRETCH
- SWIMMING
- TREADMILL
- WARM UP
- WEIGHTS
- WORK OUT
- YOGA

SECRET MESSAGE: exercise is the key to a healthy mind

'ONE STOP SHOP' DIRECTORY



MACQUARIE
PLUMBING & GAS

Jacob Perry
LIC #336885C

0488 960 874
jacob.perry64@yahoo.com.au

**DOMESTIC
WATER
DELIVERIES**



Servicing
**WELLINGTON
& REGION**

Fiona: 0427 463 441
Ken: 0427 463 442



T & N
AUTO & AG SERVICES

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AGRI TOPICS

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FIRSTLY, as this is our last AGRITOPICS for the year I wish all readers of the ‘Leader’ especially readers of the rural page, a very happy joyful and holy Christmas and happy New Year.

The weather over the public holidays will be fine and mild tops of 28 to 32 degrees, lows of 14 degrees. Chance of rain on Friday 19, Sat 20, Mon 22, Sat 27. Last week we measured 30mm on Thursday and then on Saturday I measured a further 30mm.

Spare a thought for those living in Canada where last week the temperature dropped to minus 53 degrees C,

Managing the fallow period for optimum water conservation and nitrogen availability.

Weed management has been found to be the most effective means of conserving soil moisture during the summer fallow as opposed to flattening of stubble (EG with a Coolaman harrow) had only limited impact.

In autumn and winte, residue cover can play a role reducing soil evaporation quite effectively. If climate change leads to more prolonged dry periods, increasing farmer awareness of the consequences of alternate management of summer fallows will have significant benefits to the cropping industry.

This study suggests that appropriate summer weed control could result in up to 35mm of additional stored water which should result in wheat yields of 1.3t/ha. In dry years this can sometimes be the difference between harvesting a crop or not.

Agsafe is about to launch a new service - The recycling of bulka bags and woolpacks at their depots watch this space. This will be a great service to keep your sheds free of vermin and snakes. Agsafe is keen to hear from you in a short survey that gives your chance to tell them what’s working well and where they can do better.
reply (memberservices@agsafe.org.au

MARKETS AT A GLANCE

CATTLE: CTLX Carcoar 9th 4099 head up 548. Mostly feeder weight cattle, some lighter secondary cattle. Limited heavy cattle, large cow and heifer numbers. Prime yearling steers dropped 15c, 432c to 470c, heifers firm 340c to 442c/kg. Feeder steers steady, 410c to 546c, heifers 10c cheaper, 420c to 448c/kg. Light steers to restockers to 543c, heifers to 428c/kg. Grown steers firm to cheaper, 356c to 465c, heifers back 10c, 368c to 463c/kg. Cows 10c cheaper, 2 and 3 scores 300c to 392c, heavy cows, 388c to 412c/kg. Heavy bulls to 410c/kg.

SHEEP -CTLX CARCOAR 10th. 3807sheep (-338), 5706 lambs (+648). Mostly light new season lambs suitable for restockers. Light new season lambs to processors down \$20, \$120 to \$185. Trade 20kg to 24kg firm to dearer, \$244 to \$270, ave 1090c to 1130c/kg cwt. Heavies back \$8, \$225 to \$293. Young lambs to restockers \$72 to \$230. Trade old lambs \$180 to \$265. Heavy lambs \$254 to \$310. Heavy hoggets to \$240. **Mutton** prices eased \$10. Merino ewes \$133 to \$220 and crossbred \$175 to \$240. Heavy Dorper ewes to \$260, Merino wethers to \$174. Most sheep 700c to 760c/kg cwt.

PRODUCE. Corn in USA at record prices, most other grains firm to lower. Prices mostly holding in NSW with canola in strong demand. We may not see price rises till March 2026. Monola price is very strong.

Merchandise stocks to clear below cost



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT
Week ending December 12, 2025
AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$24/25	This Week M24/25	Last Sale \$23/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2162	2107	2133	+29	1677	+485
18	2047	2035	2013	+34	1504	+543
19	1929	1916	1909	+20	1412	+517
20	1854n	1852	1826n	+28	1350n	+504
21	-	1846	-	-	-	-
26	754n	756	755n	-1	574n	+180
28	670n	666	645n	+25	397n	+96
MC	807n	764n	807n	0	709n	+98

Not frightened by a large offering

LAST WEEK the wool market challenged the theory of larger weekly offering size leading to a softer result, with the EMI lifting 21 cents in an offering of more than 40,000 bales. The gains were spread over both sale days, with all the Merino indicators improving by 20 to 30 cents, skirtings continue to out-perform the fleece rises, cardings were slightly stronger, and crossbreds showed mainly modest price lifts. Interestingly Macwool and Carmichael wool had the two top crossbred prices for the week which is a rare feat. The sentiment that has been evident since the market had its large gains some three months ago has almost gone full circle. The fearless drive of prices in the first two weeks, followed by the retreat along with questioning by processors about supposed lack of wool availability and demand from consumers that lasted four weeks, to the now recognition that even though the industry is highlighting lower sheep numbers and a smaller production forecast, an ongoing shift in consumer sentiment that favours all the ecological and environmental benefits wool has to offer in fashion and day to day wearing. The top four Northern hemisphere markets of the UK, Italy, Germany and Japan are reflecting the upbeat retail hype, with suits, coats, knitwear and next to skin options for sport and outdoors starting to be put on the shelf. Even America has seen an improvement in wool and natural fibre consumption, and with trading conditions and inflation looking favourable in these locations, price improvement could continue. Short term history tells us that we have seen higher price levels, particularly at the finer end, but with the cost of living in many parts of the world being high on the agenda, it will most likely be difficult to reach the high points of 2018. This week will be the last wool sale for the year, with a similar quantity of a little more than 40,000 bales to be offered across the three selling centres on both days for all. Macwool and Carmichael wool had around 1200 bales to go under the hammer on Tuesday.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE yarded 9500. Plainer quality yarding – dry conditions affecting. Large numbers of cows with calves, growers are lightening numbers. Fair numbers of prime cattle in all sections. Not all regular buyers operating. Young trade cattle around firm, vealers and yearlings 360c to 480c/kg. Feeder steers and lightweight heifers up to 20c cheaper, heavier heifers firm. Feeder steers 410c to 509c, heifers 388c to 460c/kg. Young restocker cattle firm, young steers to 550c, heifers to 495c/kg. Grown steers and heifers up to 12c cheaper, steers 400c to 481c/kg, heifers 390c to 456c/kg. Secondary cows up to 15c cheaper, properly finished heavy cows up to 30c/kg cheaper. Two and 3 score cows to processors 304c to 376c/kg. Heavy cows 330c to 410c, ave 376c/kg. Cows to restockers 150c to 368c/kg. Heavy bulls to 422c/kg.

DUBBO LAMBS yarded 15,800 for the last sale of the year. Quality mixed, most lambs in plain condition, some good runs of heavy shorn lambs. Large numbers of Dorpers, regular supply of hoggets. Most regular buyers operating. Light processing lambs to 18kg firm to cheaper, \$85 to \$200. Trade lambs 20kg to 24kg back \$10, \$200 to \$281, ave 1100c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs over 24kg \$20 cheaper, \$230 to \$338, ave 1050c/kg cwt. Young lambs to restockers to \$220, heavy hoggets to \$250.

MUTTON. 13,200 mixed quality, prices eased. Merino ewes \$114 to \$236, crossbred ewes, \$155 to \$308. Merino wethers to \$235, crossbred wethers to \$208. Rams to \$180/head. Most sheep sold in the range of 680c to 740c/kg cwt.

STORE CATTLE. 3333 head. Last

store sale for year. Mostly Angus and Angus cross weaners and yearlings. Smaller buying group prices cheaper, steers down \$200 to \$300, heifers back \$150 to \$200. Light weaner steers to 200kg \$750 to \$1220, ave 600c/kg. Medium weights \$1110 to \$1625, heavy weaner steers \$1360 to \$1930, most selling 500c to 550c/kg. Light weaner heifers \$605 to \$830. Medium heifers \$850 to \$1380, heavies \$1230 to \$1500, ave 400c to 440c/kg. Yearling steers to \$1900, ave 450c to 500c/kg. Yearling heifers to \$1360, ave 360c to 410. Cow/calf units cheaper, majority Angus types \$1300 to \$2690, PTIC cows \$2240 to \$2500 **WOOL.** The larger 40,000-plus bale offering and higher Aussie dollar had proven to be a stumbling block the past few months, so last week’s positive market result was a pleasing outcome. Tuesday opened dearer and finished with the NRI climbing 13 cents. Wednesday followed a similar pattern gaining a further 8 cents, pushing the NRI to its second highest weekly close this season. In the space of just 17 selling weeks, we have seen the market rise 326 cents, decline 160 cents and regain 134 cents. With just one week remaining before annual three-week recess there is potential of heading into the break at a seasonal high point. Another 40,000 bale offering in that final sale with that same quantity seemingly easily absorbed. Last week. 38,428 bales were sold, with 5.8%passed-in.. Major buyers included Techwool (dominating the Merino offering) supported by Endeavour and PJ Morris. More wool is being offered nationally on a weekly basis that what is being tested, as the pattern of a sell down in older held stock continues whilst the market rises.

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Warren

MOVING ON from his memorable win on Dances With Hooves in the recent Mudgee Cup, apprentice jockey Jacob Stiff rode a winning double on Phils Colours and Elite Power, before a big crowd on Friday at the Warren twilight meeting.

Sharon Jeffries was one of the first to identify the talent possessed by Jacob Stiff and the Parkes trainer has now won successive races with Phils Colours at Grenfell (\$2.50), Dubbo (\$12) and Warren (\$11)) with the highly promising apprentice in the saddle.

Lorraine Mcphee, from Forbes is a part owner of Phils Colours and she was trackside at Warren to see the much-improved galloper win the 1400m Western Farm Machinery Benchmark 50 Handicap.

Nicely positioned behind the leading quartet by Jacob Stiff, Phils Colours (\$11) finished well on the inside for a half-length win from Not My Problem (Kody Nestor, \$9.50) and Exceed The Sky (Izzy Neale, \$11).

Although only having five starts to date, Elite Power has already raced in Victoria, Queensland and New South Wales.

Resuming from a spell and first up for Dubbo trainer Michael Mulholland, Elite Power was an impressive winner of the 1200m Matt’s Mates Maiden Plate.

Apprenticed to Michael Mulholland, Jacob Stiff had his mount travelling well in fifth spot and Elite Power (\$2.35 fav) when given more rein accelerated on the inside to win by almost three lengths from Happy Gee Gee (Izzy Neale, \$17) and Fruit Of De Vine (Clayton Gallagher, \$2.50).

Another Dubbo-based apprentice Izzy Neale as a replacement rider for the Brett Thompson, Wellington trained Jade Division, made the most of the opportunity with a good display in the 1200m Nutrien Ag Solutions Benchmark 50 Handicap.

Pushed through a gap at the top of the straight, Jade Division (\$2.25 fav) wore down Loud (Jacob Stiff, \$16) to win by a long-head with Giovanna Star (Clayton Gallagher, \$4) coming from well back for third.

Following recent good runs, the Ashley Gibson, Gilgandra trained Alpine Rose (Ken Dunbar, \$3.40 to \$3.10) led from the outset when beating Hasime (Izzy Neale, \$3.30) and Notleanormean (Mikayla Weir, \$2.80 fav) in the 1600m AFF Class 1 & Maiden Plate.

Prominent trainer Jane Clement who recently moved from Bendemeer to Mendooran, won the 1600m Warren Community Twilights Benchmark 58 Handicap with the nine-year-old grey gelding Toulon Factor (\$5) which was well ridden in front by apprentice Bronte Simpson for a four-lengths win over Not Too Bad (James Rogers, \$51) and Wing Nut (Clayton Gallagher, \$2.30 fav).

Making it two wins from the last three starts, the Ross Lomax, Mudgee-trained Desirous (Mikayla Weir, \$3.80) led and held off the fast finishing Champ De Mars (Jacob Stiff, \$3.90 to \$3.60 fav) by tywo lengths while Advisor (Brontë Simpson, \$19) was another length away third in the 1000m Business DNA Benchmark 50 Handicap.

Racing at Dubbo on Saturday followed by Bathurst, December 23, Wellington Boxing Day December 26, Gilgandra December 27 and Orange December 30.

Home for Christmas?

Then bring the family for a relaxing day at

BOXING DAY RACES

Friday, 26 December



Wellington Public School Band Visit



Last week we had the Elebana Public School Band entertain us with their musical ability and performance skills. They played a range of tunes and we all enjoyed clapping and singing along. One of the highlights for us was when they invited our band members up on stage to join them in a performance.



Wellington Diggers Swimming Club



THIRTEEN members participated in our weekly swim on Tuesday, December 9. Terry Dray won the 30-metre event for the second week running being 0.06 outside his time. Katharine O'Rourke won the 50-metre event being 0.41 outside her time. Tilly Hill won the 30-metre junior event with Albert Rich winning the 50-metre event. Nick Knowles and Henry Willcockson won the Brace Relay being 2.03 outside their time.

Last Tuesday 16th was our last swim for 2025 our first Swim in 2026 will be Tuesday, January 6. Swimming commences at 6pm each Tuesday at the Aquatic Leisure Centre. To compete in our weekly swim adults must be members of the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club and for juniors to compete a family member must compete on the night. Membership is \$2 for adults, swim cost is \$5 per person plus pool entry. After swim BBQ is included. The Western District Championships will be held in Cobar on Sunday, February 8, 2026. New Members are always welcome and for more information contact

Terry Dray – 0408 294 526.
Results
Juniors
30 Metre: 1 Tilly Hill 0.50+; 2 Rhylee Hill 1.19+; 3 Albert Rich 3.07+.
50 Metre: 1 Albert Rich 1.97+; 2 Darcy Lousick 6.28+; 3 Rhylee Hil 9.37+.
Seniors
30 Metre: 1 Terry Dray 0.06-; 2 Donna Cosier 0.38+; 3 Henry Willcockson 0.41.
50 Metre: 1 Katharine O'Rourke 0.41-; 2 Terry Dray 0.78+; 3 Nick Knowles 0.84-.
Brace Relay: 1 Nick Knowles & Henry Willcockson 2.03+; 2 Albert Rich & Katharine O'Rourke 6.13+; 3 Darcy Lousick & Rhylee Hill 6.22+.
The Platypus

What Tanmalangaloo and Wellington have in common - hint, racing

Boxing Day races have always been a family tradition in Wellington. Every year the racecourse fills with Wellington and the region's families who use the race meeting for true family relaxation after the hectic lead up to the big day of the year – Christmas Day. Interestingly, one year will have a very large crowd of upwards to 800 people, then the next year the crowd is lower and down to around 300. Like anywhere else, it's a Wellington thing as we all know families take turns of hosting the annual Christmas festivities, which explains the large or smaller crowds. When one reads the poetry of John O'Brien, Boxing Day comes large as life when the Bishop visits a small bush school out the back of nowhere for Confirmation. After picking his 'mark' he



asks the lad why is Christmas Day the greatest of the year. The ready answer bared a fact no Bishop ever knew – "It's the day before the races at Tanmalangaloo" Our Boxing Day crowds are not all pagans, but families who enjoy the relaxing feature of the day with some having a small

punt. It's a community meeting of five races, which attract good fields even though it's the peak Christmas period. So, Wellington Race Club invites all who may be in the Central West and Orana regions this Christmas, to join the many families who return year-after-year most often than not.

All set for a big footy season



Redbacks senior coaches for 2026 season.

WELLINGTON REDBACKS has announced coaches for the 2026 winter Ruby Union season. Seniors men's coaches are Abe Dearmer and Sam Webster while female coaches are Snow Brien and Pip Randell. Juniors have an array of top-notch coaches starting with Hamish Doherty and Sam Redfern looking after the Under 6s. Grant and Mitch Spradbrow will be

in charge of the Under 8s while Sam Frogley and Malcolm Ney will coach the Under 10s. The winning combination of Dugald Campbell and Norm Smith continue this year with the Under 12s with Grant Spradbrow the team's manager. Under 14s will be under the scrutiny of Kym Dorin and Snow Brien with Eddie Owenr their trainer, and Josh Bullock will train the Under 16s.

Guys and Dolls addition to 2026 Boot

FOR DECADES it was for the girls, but times have changed and so too does competition entries. The 2026 Wellington Boot race that stops not only Wellington, but the Central West and Orana regions, has an exciting addition. What used to be the Ms Wellington Boot challenge is returning, but with a twist – the Challenge is open to males and females aged from 18 to 30 years of age. Featured at the Tooheys 2026 Wellington Boot Guys and Dolls Challenge, the contest has only 14 available positions and when nominations open early next year, they'll fill quick. It's a bit far away, April 10 and 12 next year, but the promotion has begun and information pamphlets will be distributed at the Boxing Day races.

The 14 Challenge contestants will be hosts of sponsors, *Wellington Soldiers Memorial and Golf Group, Wellington and District Leader newspaper, Wellington Race Club and Tooheys*. Nominations will only be received at the Soldiers Club and contestants will be drawn out of a barrel during the pre-Boot Calcutta on the evening of Saturday, April; 11, then guest of all sponsors on Boot race day. All each contestant has to do is draw a Boot runner at the Calcutta, they follow the big day of



The *Leader's* Sharon Wilson and *Wellington Soldiers' Jane Angelini* show-off the wonderful Guys and Dolls Challenge sashes all ready for the 2026 Wellington Boot.

racing on Sunday, April 12, and with some luck hold the ticket of the winner or second or third placings to share in the beaut prizes on offer. More details to come, so, be ready to nominate when the date is announced sometime in February or March.

Mayor congratulates colouring-in winners

Hundreds of students across the region have taken part in the Dubbo Region Christmas Colouring-In competition, celebrating the Christmas spirit and winning vouchers for their school. Mayor Josh Black said all the entries showed character and creativity. "While the children were asked to colour-in the Australian animals on the sheet, they were also given some space to draw themselves and that's where their creativity really shone,"

he said. "As a result of their creative talents five children have won a \$200 My-DubboRegion gift voucher for their school to use at a local business in the Dubbo region," The winners of the 2025 competition were: Lacey from Wellington Public School; Maddie from Stuart Town Public School; Nethaya from St John's Primary School; Ellanor from Orana Heights Public School and Kenzie from St Laurence's Primary School.

Secure Digital Birth Certificate to make it easier to prove who you are

PEOPLE IN NSW are moving into a new digital era with the state government recently previewing the new Digital Birth Certificate ahead of its release next year. Planned for initial release to people aged 16 to 21, the Digital Birth Certificate is built to the international standard and will be available within the Service NSW app. The new digital document aims to make it easy to locate a birth certificate on your phone, whenever and wherever you need it, without having to dig through drawers and storage boxes for the paper version. A Digital Birth Certificate provides secure access to this vital identity document and will allow the user greater control over which information they share and who they share it with. In the first stage of the roll-out planned for

March 2026, the Digital Birth Certificate will be made available to 16–21-year-olds born in NSW who hold a photo card or driver licence. Service NSW and the Registry of Births, Deaths and Marriages are engaging industry leaders to ensure the document will be widely accepted in future by government, businesses, schools, clubs and sporting organisations, making it easier to register and apply for services people need. Young adults with a Digital Birth Certificate will initially be able to use it at Service NSW centres to apply for certain NSW Government transactions like the Responsible Service of Alcohol (RSA) and Responsible Conduct of Gambling (RCG) competency card. The Digital Birth Certificate will be optional for those who are eligible to participate.

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Andrew GEE MP

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ST COLUMBA'S CATHOLIC PRIMARY SCHOOL

MASS AND PRESENTATION EVENING 2025

What a night in Yeoval!

I had a terrific time at the mighty St Columba's Catholic Primary School presentation night.

Congratulations to Principal Glenn Corben, the teachers, students, and the whole school community.

Thank you Fr Carl Mackander for a lovely Mass.

I had the honour of presenting awards to some of their outstanding young students:

Annie, Lucy & Georgia — Cabonne Shire Council Award for Creative Arts

Logan — Little River Landcare Award for the Environment

Georgia, Mitchell & Morgan — Andrew Gee Award for Leadership

Well done St Columba's Primary on a great year of achievements and I wish you all the very best for 2026!



YEOVAL CENTRAL SCHOOL'S 2025

PRESENTATION EVENING

Last week I had the honour of attending the Yeoval Central School's Presentation Evening.

Well done to all the students from Kindy to Year 12 on a successful year of growth, learning and achievements.

I really enjoyed their presentation on all the awesome activities they engaged in during 2025 — from cross country races to youth parliament and work experience.

A special shout out to the school captains for 2026!

Sophia & Audrey
Primary School Captains

Ethan & Lance Isaiah
Secondary School Captains

Congratulations to Principal Ms Trish Henderson, the passionate teachers, all the students, and your very supportive and connected school community.



Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area



- ✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purposebuilt wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School

✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project

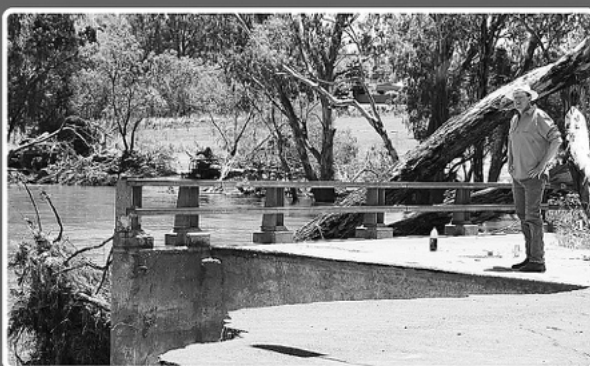
✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges

✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge

✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park

✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge



✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre

✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves

✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at Maranatha House

✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities

✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room

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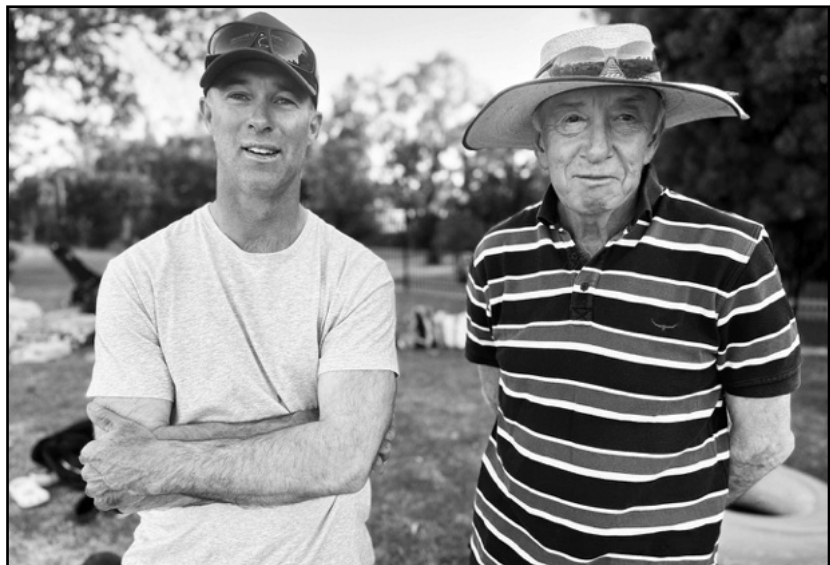
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Authorised by Andrew Gee, MP, Suite 1/179A Anson Street, Orange NSW 2800

More of Santa's Visit - Carmen Gain Photos



Strong performances at Dunedoo carnival

LOCAL SWIMMERS enjoyed a successful and action-packed day at the Dunedoo Swimming Carnival last Sunday, with seven competitors producing impressive results across a wide range of events.

Olive Smith and Reign Smith both secured medals in their respective age groups in the 25-metre events, while Ned Frogley finished third in both breaststroke and freestyle.

Elsie Gain delivered an outstanding performance, claiming first place in freestyle, breaststroke and butterfly, and third place in backstroke.

Roman Dowton was the standout performer of the meet, winning all of his races and breaking multiple long-standing records.

Dowton set a new Boys 10 Years 66m Short Course Butterfly record with a time of 55.35, surpassing the previous mark of 1:01.15.

He also broke the Boys 10 and Under 100m Short Course Butterfly record with a time of 1:34.94 (old record 1:46.15) and the Boys 10 and Under 100m Short Course Breaststroke record in 1:44.40 (old record 1:56.12).

Both Dowton and Gain qualified for the highly competitive 10 and Under Skins event, where the top six swimmers race with the slowest eliminated after each round.

Gain, just eight-years-old, showed remarkable determination competing against older swimmers, entering the event in sixth position and finishing fourth overall.

Dowton, the fastest qualifier, went on to win the Skins event in a thrilling final race.

In the 11 years age group, Brodie Frogley and Sage Smith swam strongly, narrowly missing podium finishes in all of their events.

The carnival concluded with the age relays, where the local team doubled up in several races.

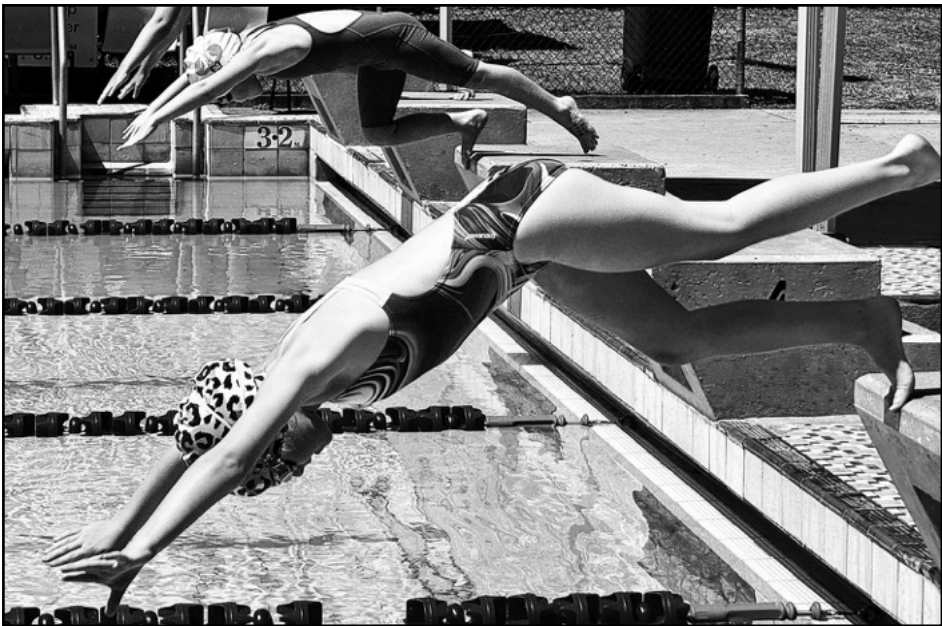
Reign Smith, Olive Smith, Ned Frogley and Elsie Gain finished third in the 8 and Under relay. The 10 and Under relay team of Elsie Gain, Ned Frogley, Roman Dowton and a Coonabarabran swimmer claimed second place.

In the 12 years and under relay, Sage Smith, Brodie Frogley, Roman Dowton and a Coonabarabran swimmer finished just outside the medals, narrowly missing bronze behind the Mudgee Marlins.

Overall, it was a highly successful day for the swimmers, highlighted by record-breaking performances, strong team efforts and impressive sportsmanship.

Last Friday night's Pointscore was cancelled due to the thunderstorms.

Carmen Gain



Touch Round 9 - Jo Ivey Photos

Break until February 4 still anyone's grand win

WELLINGTON TOUCH held its final round for the year yesterday afternoon (Wednesday, December 17), with A and B Grades taking the field for Round 9. C and D Grades have a bye and have already concluded their matches for 2025.

In A Grade, Fast Eddie Owens Plumbing continues to set the pace, sitting undefeated at the top of the ladder with eight wins from eight games.

They are followed closely by FORME, who sit just two points behind in second place.

The mid-table battle remains tight, with Bell River Hay and Wolf Pack locked on 17 points each.

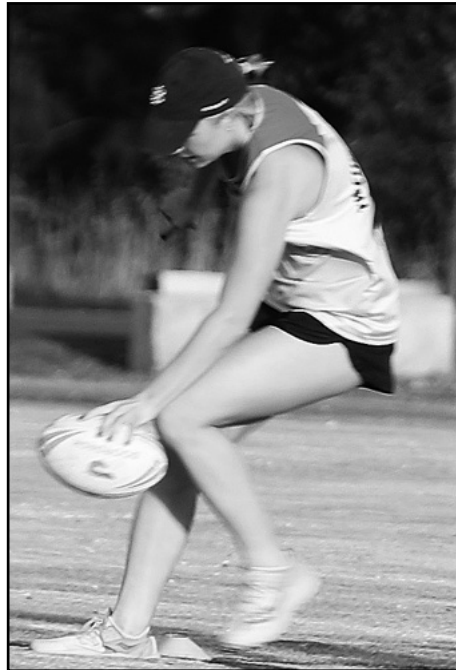
B Grade competition has Lousicks leading the pack on 22 points, having lost only one game this season.

NF Electrical holds second place, while Arthurville and Let It Snow round out the top four, sitting level on 16 points.

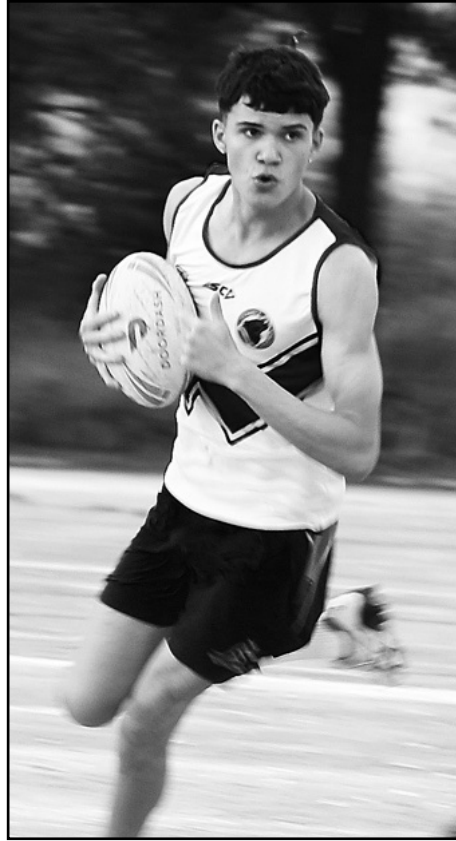
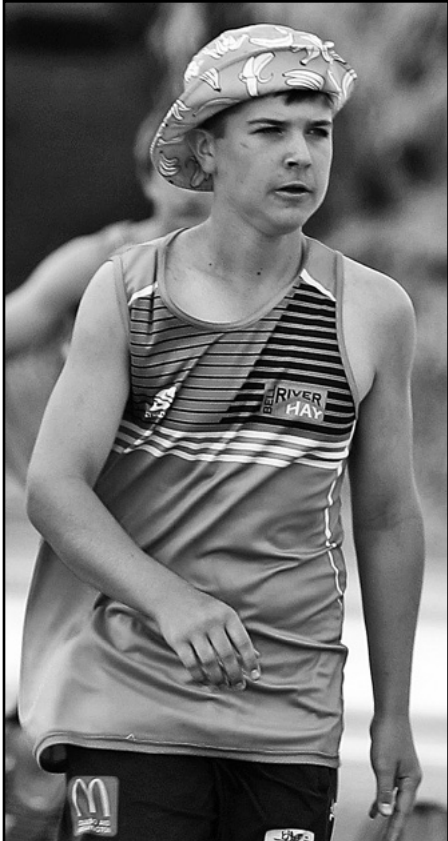
Following this week's matches, the competition will break for the festive season and is scheduled to recommence on Wednesday, February 4, 2026.

Merry Christmas to all.

Abe Dearmer



Touch Round 9 - Jo Ivey Photos



Golfing News

Peter Payne Clubman of the Year

GOLF CLUB presentation night was performed by candlelight with a blackout in the area last Saturday night.

The Club person of the year was awarded to Peter Payne for all his time spent volunteering on the course, congratulations Peter you deserved this award.

Last Saturday's events were a Stroke event plus Round 2 of the Naveau Earthmoving Trophy, and Round 3 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer competition.

A grade Medal of Medals winner was Nathan Stewart while B grade Medal of Medals winner was Peter Holden.

Winner of the Naveau Earthmoving Trophy and a great prize to win was Marie Cornish who put together two great rounds of golf to claim the prize.

Winner of the day's golf was David East who finished with 65nett. Runner-up was Marie Cornish finishing with a 69nett on a countback.

Prize winners were Brock Naden, Malcolm Payne, Denise Haesler 69netts; Mathew Reid, Steve Kiss, Jono Smith 70; Kurt Cusack, Gary McCarroll 71; Cody Conn, Brad Conn, Elton Keeffe 72; Mitchell Cusack, Joe Ryan 73; Peter Holden, Joe Mason 74; Nathan Stewart 75 on c/b.

Nearest the Pins on 3rd no result, 8th Nathan Stewart, 14th Joe Mason, 16th Malcolm Payne.

Jespresso Cafe longest drives went to Kurt Cusack in A grade and Drew Stone in B grade.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by David Wilson who reintroduced himself to plenty of trees, final score 89nett.

Wednesday's ladies golf was an Individual Stableford won by Mark Hull who showed the ladies a clean pair of heels to finish with 39pts.



A grade Foursomes Champions Kurt and Mitchell Cusack with their father, Gary, sponsor.

Runner-up was Marie Cornish who finished with 35pts. Prize winner was Noella Baker.

Thursday's Individual Stableford winner was John Gersbach and good to see him finish a round of golf as well, final score 33pts on a countback.

Runner-up also on 33 was Joe Ryan.

Prize winner was Peter Holden with 32pts on a c/b.

Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 9-hole Round 9 winner was Malcolm Payne with 32nett on a countback. Runner-up went to Nate Ryan with an 32nett.

Raffle winner was James Fleming.

Front nine to be played this week.

Results of Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer comp Round 1:- Bell River Bandits drew with Kevaliers, Railway Boys defeated Dirt Diggers 1up, Dirty Birds defeated Snipers 1up, WMC drew with Lion of Waterloo, Soldiers Club drew with Pheonix, The Masters defeated Used Groceries 2up, Maulers defeated Power Rangers 3up.



B grade Foursomes Champions Rod McMahon, Noel Stanford with sponsor Gary Cusack (Butchery).

Round 2 results were Bell River Bandits defeated Dirt Diggers 5up, Lion of Waterloo defeated Railway Boys 5up, Kevaliers defeated The Dirty Birds 3up, Snipers drew with Pheonix, WMC defeated The Masters 2up, Maulers defeated Soldiers Club 1up, Used Groceries defeated Power Rangers 1up.

Round 3 matches are Bell River Bandits taking on Lion of Waterloo, Dirty Birds v Pheonix, Dirt Diggers v The Masters, Kevaliers v Maulers, Railway Boys v Power Rangers, Snipers v Used Groceries, Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws v Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club.

Points table will be available at the Golf Club.

All Golfers are reminded to get your Memberships finalised as soon as possible. Memberships Fees can be paid at the Soldiers Memorial Club during office hours.

This Saturday's events are an Individual Stableford plus round 4 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition. **19th Hole**

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

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STARTS FROM 7.30PM**

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

**NEW YEAR'S EVE
Dance Party**

WITH DJ TJ SIMPSON!

31ST DECEMBER 2025
STARTS 7:30PM
PARTY UNTIL LATE
SEE THE NEW YEAR IN ON THE D-FLOOR

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

NO BINGO!
Christmas Break

STARTS 23 DEC, 24TH, 25TH, 30TH, 31ST

RETURN ON 1ST JAN
FOR BINGO MARATHON

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ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST

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5.30PM
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**BINGO
Marathon**

1 JANUARY 2026, NEW YEAR'S DAY!

40 GAMES TO BE PLAYED
TIX ON SALE AT 12PM | FIRST GAME AT 12:30PM

BREAK AT 2:30PM WITH TIX ON SALE FOR
AFTERNOON GAMES AT 3:30PM

SECOND ROUND STARTS AT 4PM
AND FINISHES AT 6PM

BOOKINGS ESSENTIAL

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

**MEMBERS BADGE DRAW
TUESDAY'S
FRIDAY'S
SUNDAY'S**

The prize bank is growing! Don't miss out!
You must be at the Club to Win!

**CASH FEVER
FRIDAY'S
SUNDAY'S**

DRAWN BETWEEN 6.30PM TO 8.30PM